

Reviews for [CMSC330](#)

Sort By:	Rating	Professor Filter:	All Professors
Information	Review		
Cliff Bakalian CMSC330 ★☆☆☆☆ Anonymous 02/21/2026	Listen, I'm not saying Cliff is a bad guy, but my pharmacist is about to go out of business because of him. Here is a draft of that story, punch-up comedian style. Feel free to post this on your socials—it's got that "relatable academic trauma" vibe that usually does numbers. The Cure for Insomnia (Or: Why My Pharmacist Hates Cliff) I've been on prescription-strength melatonin for years, right? My blood is basically 40% cherry-flavored sleep aid. I thought I was a medical mystery—a man whose brain simply refused to log off. Then I met Cliff. Cliff doesn't give lectures; he performs "auditory anesthesia." His voice isn't a human voice—it's the sound of a dial-up modem trying to connect in a rainstorm. It's the sonic equivalent of watching beige paint dry in slow motion. Last week, I walked into Cliff's room, he said, "Good morning, class, let's look at the sub-sections of paragraph B," and I was out. I didn't just nap; I entered a coma so deep I saw my ancestors. My Fitbit actually sent a notification to my emergency contacts because it thought I had passed away. I've officially cancelled my prescription. Why pay a \$20 co-pay for pills when I can just sit in the back row of Cliff's class for free? He is a biological miracle. If we could bottle his energy, we could solve the world's stress levels in a weekend, mostly because everyone would be unconscious. The only problem? Anwar. See, I actually want to pass Course 330. Anwar is the problem because he's actually... engaging? He's funny, he's got energy, he makes 330 feel like a Netflix special. I'm sitting there in Anwar's class, wide awake, learning things, and laughing. It's disgusting. I'm actually retaining information. So now I have a system: I go to Anwar to pass the degree. I go to Cliff to achieve the deepest REM cycle known to man. If you see me sprinting from Anwar's room to Cliff's, don't worry. I'm just heading to my bedroom.		
Anwar Mamat CMSC330 ★★☆☆☆ Expecting an A- Anonymous 01/27/2026	This class was extremely boring, not well taught, and not useful. Projects were fine. He seems nice as a professor but I could not for the life of me stay focused while he rambles on just pointing at stuff in the code editor in a dry voice. I wouldn't recommend taking this course.		

Information	Review
Cliff Bakalian CMSC330 ☆☆☆☆☆ Expecting an A Anonymous 01/22/2026	Doesn't really matter if you take Cliff or Anwar for 330 as they coteach (same quizzes, projects, exams, schdule, etc.). If you don't like Cliff's slides/notes, you can see Anwar's. If you don't like Cliff's lectures, you can go to Anwar's. I went to both and Cliff is slightly more boring, but I also find the material boring in general. This is easily one of the most organized CS classes at UMD. Everything is very clearly communicated, and the course website is SO useful. Every past quiz and exam is available to study with (as well as their answer keys). The TAs are obviously very close with Cliff and seem to enjoy their job, which definitely makes the class feel sort of homey. My biggest complaint were some exam questions were really more reliant on logic than on understanding of the material. These were the minority, but still. Also, Cliff/Anwar both sent out an email to everyone, accusing "many" people in the class of using AI on projects. They offered the usual "snitch on yourself or we'll sent you to OSC". My problem with this is that they sent this a few weeks before finals, and said they wouldn't report anyone until after finals. So, everyone had the threat of a potential false AI accusation looming over their heads throughout finals. Imo it's unprofessional to punish the entire class instead of just contacting/reporting those individuals directly. Also I knew of no one who was reported, so it's somewhat likely they lied to get people to turn themselves in (since you can't really prove AI usage anyways).
Anwar Mamat CMSC330 ☆☆☆☆☆ Anonymous 01/15/2026	He is genuinely a very kind and approachable professor, and I would definitely recommend taking CMSC330 with him. While the course itself is certainly challenging, he creates a welcoming and supportive learning environment that truly makes a difference. He is patient, warm, and always considerate of his students, which helps make a difficult class feel much more manageable and encouraging.
Cliff Bakalian CMSC330 ☆☆☆☆☆ Expecting an A+ Anonymous 01/11/2026	this class was SO easy because of how practical its content is. i literally got a 101% and probably spent at most a 5 hours a week outside of the class on it. you learn about functional programming and regex which are extremely important concepts no matter what language youre using, and then you get to learn a little about compilers which is fun! cliff at times would start talking about something without saying what we were learning about which was a bit confusing, but everyone got the point eventually. he did put me to sleep a bit, but you can understand him still! i am someone who prefers a more organized teaching style usually, but i enjoyed his more laid back approach for a change tbh. this class is also the complete opposite of 351, if you do the practice exams you will know every single question type that is on the exam/quizzes and there are no curveballs. he was a little slow on releasing the projects, but he made them easier when he was behind so im not complaining.
Anwar Mamat CMSC330 ☆☆☆☆☆ Anonymous 01/05/2026	He's a good professor and a warm person in general. I would recommend him for CMSC330 since I think he's better at teaching than Cliff.
Cliff Bakalian CMSC330 ☆☆☆☆☆ Expecting an A Anonymous 12/26/2025	I would put 3.5 stars if I could. Cliff is a very average professor. His lectures are boring and long, but that's most CS professors tbh. I can't think of anything he does that's terrible, but I also can't think of anything he does that's especially noteworthy. If you just pay attention during lectures and discussions, you'll be fine.
Cliff Bakalian CMSC330 ☆☆☆☆☆ Expecting an A Anonymous 12/25/2025	Not good at teaching and very good at making simple things hard and hard things impossible. Take Anwar if you can. If you must take him, either go to Anwar's lectures & study/review based on his notes or go to Cliff's lectures and risk annoying the entire class by asking questions every 10 minutes because he can't teach without confusing people like so.

Information	Review
Cliff Bakalian CMSC330 ★☆☆☆☆ Expecting an A Anonymous 12/25/2025	Do not recommend Cliff at all. His lectures are extremely unhelpful and he has a cocky attitude when speaking with students. Also, most of his TAs (besides a couple that were really helpful) never answer student questions on piazza and hold useless discussions. I strongly suggest taking Anwar's section instead. Not only is he a better lecturer, he seems to care more about his students.
Anwar Mamat CMSC330 ★☆☆☆☆ Expecting an A+ Anonymous 12/24/2025	This class is probably the worst out of all the lower level CS classes in its current state being ran by Mamat and Cliff. It is ran very unprofessionally and poorly. Dr. Mamat, despite being a funny guy, was a horrible lecturer. He would complain that less people came to class but his lectures were genuinely so hard to follow. He posts lecture videos though which you can rewatch and there are Cliff's notes, so you can still do a decent amount of learning on your own. The previous exam solutions had a lot of errors which never got fixed, and you needed to check on piazza to see if someone had clarified the solutions were wrong for a specific question, which was annoying. It was also annoying when we randomly started doing rust with 2 weeks left to go in the semester, and the specifications for the final exam were "anything mentioned in any lecture/discussion/quiz/project up until the last day of class." Overall it's definitely not impossible to do well in this class, it's just ran very poorly which makes it frustrating at times.
Anwar Mamat CMSC330 ★★★★☆ Expecting an A Anonymous 12/24/2025	Anwar is pretty good. Him and Cliff coteach so no difference as far as exams, projects, etc. He teaches really well imo when he goes off his slides, which is about half the time. And then the other half he just does random examples on emacs which can sometimes be helpful and other times just makes things confusing. But overall he is pretty solid.
Anwar Mamat CMSC330 ★★★★☆ Expecting an A- Anonymous 12/23/2025	The class honestly isn't too difficult content wise. Ocaml coding can be a slightly annoying (especially with lexer, parser, interpreter) and the rust rules may be difficult to understand at first but in the grand scheme of the course, nothing is that hard to pick up. I know many people say Anwar is an entertaining lecturer, but I went to almost every class and struggled to pay attention in every single one. Luckily he started giving out attendance extra credit but as far as what he actually taught, it was awfully boring for me and I found myself doing homework for other classes. I basically taught myself all of the content while studying for the exam or doing the projects. You could honestly chose either Cliff or Anwar for this course but it seems like Anwar was more lenient, especially with his extra credit.
Anwar Mamat CMSC330 ★★★★☆ Expecting an A+ Anonymous 12/22/2025	Here is the thing, he really just isn't that good of a lecturer. He can be very disorganized, and he can forget to share vital information unless a student explicitly asks. I think his exams/projects were pretty fair. His projects can be a bit tough, but they certainly help you prepare for the exams so make sure to spend time on them.
Anwar Mamat CMSC330 ★★★★☆ Expecting a B Anonymous 12/02/2025	Look as a person this guy is great he is funny and has good interaction with his students. However, he may be one of the worst lecturers I have had in terms of learning comprehension. Most of the slides are not in order to his material and often he transitions into examples that sure are useful but then take up a lot of time. As a result theory is much less covered which is a large issue for a class based heavily in it
Anwar Mamat CMSC330 ★★★★★ Expecting an A Anonymous 11/15/2025	Gave good examples during class and in his notes which helped with assignments in the course, especially projects. Lectures are definitely disorganized at times with him jumping around content. But when he is focused, you are able to learn a lot in class plus he is a funny guy. Anwar or Cliff? Doesn't matter. The course is the same no matter what so just choose the lecture time that works best for your schedule.

Information	Review
Anwar Mamat CMSC330 ★☆☆☆☆ Anonymous 09/27/2025	Very nice, wholesome guy who cracks some jokes during lecture. However, easily one of the worst lecturers I've ever had. Any reviews saying that all he does in class is open up emacs and type up random examples in a sleep-inducing kinda way are completely accurate. There doesn't seem to be any coherent order between the topics he covers during lectures, and he absolutely does not follow the corresponding lecture slides. For some topics, he covers them a week or more later than when they appear on the lecture quizzes (which are assigned Friday and due Sunday?). One big issue I have is that Anwar doesn't explain some terms at all. After going to discussion, I realized the topics are very simple and could easily be explained in like 3 seconds. All this being said, 330 has a ton of old quizzes/exams, notes, and resources to reference. It should still be easy to get a good grade if you put effort into the projects and pay attention in discussion.
Cliff Bakalian CMSC330 ★★☆☆☆ Expecting a B Anonymous 09/24/2025	To be honest, I did NOT like Cliff as a professor whatsoever. First lecture was good, then it went downhill from there. All Cliff does is yap his mind away and it is very hard to pay attention in lectures because he has a very monotone voice and very boring slides. At some point, I stopped going to lecture, and even if I did, I would NOT pay attention. By the middle/end of the semester, there were only 50 kids in the lecture hall. His slides are alright, but tbh, Anwar's material helped me learn the material better. Looking back, the concepts in 330 are not bad whatsoever, just that Ocaml is so annoying to write. He has quizzes that were aight (first one was atrocious, avg was a 9/20). His exams were also pretty straightword, not many curveballs other than putting brainrot on questions that made the question so much harder to understand and solve. PROJECTS 3-5 ARE BAD, START EARLY. For these projects, he made them longer/harder because of cheating in previous semesters. Tbh, I might recommend anwar over cliff but it really doesnt matter.
Cliff Bakalian CMSC330 ★★☆☆☆ Expecting an A+ Anonymous 09/24/2025	Cliff has a lack of professionalism that radiates throughout this entire class. He doesn't hold his TAs to any standards so they often show up late and are unhelpful during discussions and office hours. He tries to be goofy by putting bizarre "brain rot" style questions on midterms, which obviously makes the questions way harder to comprehend. He also never responds to emails. On top of all that, he's not a great lecturer. He's not the Devil. I don't want to be too harsh. But I struggle to come up with any positive contribution that Cliff made to this course that I can't also attribute to Anwar. I would recommend taking Anwar instead.
Anwar Mamat CMSC330 ★☆☆☆☆ Anonymous 09/22/2025	Not sure if Anwar is the one who does this, but I hate the structure and organization of this class. The only practice tools are old exams and quizzes which most where in a different curriculum and language entirely. The questions on old quizzes are also significantly different than the quiz I took. There are quizzes randomly assigned Friday close to midnight and due Sunday without any warning. Everything is on only on gradescope and nothing is on elms.
Cliff Bakalian CMSC330 ★★★★☆ Expecting an A- Anonymous 05/31/2025	Good teacher overall. He's a boring lecturer imo but you can easily just not go to class because his pdf notes are very well-constructed and cover everything you need. OCaml is tough, and projects 3-5 are the hardest I've had in college so far. Thankfully, only 10-20% of each exam is OCaml coding because 330 is really just a "intro to compilers" course and the theoretical/non-coding topics are pretty easy. Rust is fine. Choosing between him and Anwar doesn't matter. They share exams, projects, quizzes, and the course website, so just pick the better time.
Anwar Mamat CMSC330 ★★★★★ Expecting an A Anonymous 05/30/2025	Good professor. Quite literally no difference between him and Cliff. Though, Anwar, being more senior, might be slightly better at teaching. The exams for both professors are more or less the same. In fact, it's pretty evident that Cliff and/or the TAs make the exams given the incorporation of gen z humor. Regardless, the exams are fairly easy, and the only way you fail is if you don't actually do the projects (i.e. don't GPT projects). Both professors' resources are accessible. In fact, most of the resources can be accessed without being enrolled in the class, just search up UMD CMSC 330.

Information	Review
Anwar Mamat CMSC330 ★★★★★ Expecting an A Anonymous 05/30/2025	He's not that great of a lecturer, but he's my favorite professor. He's just the best, but not the best at teaching. He's funny too :). Class in general is easy, the projects take a little while, so I'd to starting at least 2 days before the due date. It's annoying to have a project due soon when the autograder does not work right and the readme has 500 typos. This isn't Prof. Mamat's fault, though, I'm pretty sure it's Cliff's fault. The TA's were actually good unlike CMSC351.
Cliff Bakalian CMSC330 ★☆☆☆☆ Expecting a B- Anonymous 05/28/2025	Cliff and Anwar typically are the only people who teach this. Material is the same but definitely take Anwar over Cliff. Cliff's lectures are about as boring as can be. Imagine a theatre kid mixed with a introverted CS nerd. I would have rather watched paint dry than attend another one of his lectures as it would've been more entertaining and helpful than his lectures. His notes and slides are a mess filled with snazzy little transitions that make it a nightmare to navigate. The class overall felt pretty unstructured with random topics thrown in for the s and g's. At least Anwar recorded his lectures and explained things better than Cliff's philosophical mumbling. Material is difficult but certainly doable. Start project 5 early. TA's were hit or miss. I think there were maybe one or two good ones but the rest seemed to be pretty rude, unhelpful, or overall useless. My discussion TA was late half the time and spent most of the time arguing with one student about different ways to do problems. That's all I remember until I stopped showing up to the discussion at all.
Cliff Bakalian CMSC330 ★★☆☆☆ Expecting a B Anonymous 05/24/2025	TLDR, if you have a choice between Anwar or Cliff, take Anwar (better overall lectures and more do able assessments). Cliff personally made this course much harder than it was supposed to be. I usually ended up reading Anwar's slides and examples, and eventually, watch his recordings instead to understand some weird concepts like lambda calculus. Cliff notes made it insanely harder to understand and grasp it in my opinion. The way he designed his slides is just so not intuitive at all, and makes it even harder when he doesn't record his lessons. He has philosopher style of teaching, which makes sense because he got a degree in that. But honestly, teaching cs in that kind of style just makes it harder and more complicated than it's supposed to be for students to understand this class. And remember, 330 is a required class as a cs major, so yeah this matter should be taken seriously rather than a joke. Now yes, keep in mind, 330 is a hard class (it's a 300 level course duh). So yeah regardless it wasn't going to be an easy class anyway. But I just felt like this course was insanely unstructured. They taught things too fast and concepts just felt out of place to grasp personally, especially when it's expected that many students are also taking this class with 351. I also felt like the projects were way too complicated and just weren't helpful in understanding the concepts that we learned in the course, especially project 5. And I also think we could've just learned Rust for the entire course rather than jumping into a new language after already a difficult language (OCaml) weeks before our final. Also, I despised the fact that the course used OCaml to teach us the concepts, honestly made things worse to click and understand... I just felt like if they assessed things with more structure, and actually know what kind of questions to ask on the exams, the course wouldn't have been to hard. Because honestly, the concepts were actually darn easy to grasp, and some of them were pretty cool and essential too (e.g. NFAs/DFAs).
Cliff Bakalian CMSC330 ★★★★☆ Expecting an A+ Anonymous 05/24/2025	Only complaint is that he tends to mumble sometimes, so I would recommend sitting near the front so you can hear everything he says. Solid lecturer. Makes the topics about as engaging as they can be.

Information	Review
Anwar Mamat CMSC330 ☆☆☆☆☆ Expecting an A- Anonymous 05/23/2025	Anwar is nice, but I really hate his style of teaching since it's so disengaging. Literally on the first day of class, bro just opened up Emacs and started coding random stuff, and he doesn't reference his slides at all—or barely does. It's so hard to take notes or follow along with what he's saying when he just codes for 1 hour and 15 minutes straight. Towards the end of February, I started skipping lecture since he unnecessarily went way too in-depth into the concepts and didn't teach them in the way they actually show up on the quizzes and exams. This class is nice though because the projects make up a big portion of your grade, and the exams aren't worth that much. I literally failed the first two exams and did well on the final, and I'm ending with an A- (that's telling you how easy it is to do well in this class if you lock in on projects). Quizzes are each only 2% of your grade, but they add up so try to do well on them. You just need to study 2–3 days in advance and do the practice, and you'll be fine. The TAs are way more involved in this course compared to other CS classes, but some of them clearly don't know anything about the concepts. Also, some are super unhelpful on Piazza, not directly answering questions but posting a link to something else because they're too lazy to answer LMAO. But luckily my discussion TA was super smart, so he was very helpful. Overall, this class won't be too bad, but try to study in advance and get ahead if you can to make it easier on yourself.
Cliff Bakalian CMSC330 ☆☆☆☆☆ Expecting a B- Anonymous 05/23/2025	So you came here to decide whether you should take 330 with Cliff or Anwar. Well I'm here to tell you that you should just choose one that has a better schedule for you. In terms of course structure, the projects are the most demanding part of this course. Especially project 5 (you'll see it when you get there). I know this is said in every CS course review ever, but I cannot emphasize this enough when I say that you should start these projects THE DAY they are assigned. Now I will say there were some people who would start the projects with 2–3 days before due date (most people have other overlapping courses like 351) so they can be a bit constrained for time, but still would get it done somehow. However, like I said, the projects are the most important source of learning in the course. Rushing to do them just to pass the test cases is very counterproductive. Use the projects to master the concepts you learn in class (I did NOT do this, hypocrite much??Shh keep reading) and you will see that the exams and quizzes are SO much easier. Any sort of "coding" question you get in a quiz or exam is some permutation of a function you implemented for a relevant project. So if you're not a GPT warrior and actually implemented the functions by understanding what its asking for, those questions should be a breeze. I'll be the one to say it...OCaml is really not that bad to understand (cry about it yall just work with any code that isn't written like a pseudocode). The syntax is really trivial to grasp especially if you have worked with "let" expressions in JS. HOWEVER, the functional programming aspect of it is where it gets tricky. But once you have enough practice with the first two projects (really only the first project because it is designed to teach you how functional programming in OCaml works), you will spend less time worrying about the language itself rather implementing the necessary concepts into the projects. You will *lightly* go over Rust programming towards the last 20% of the course which is a much more traditional language, and is primarily used to teach concepts on type safety. All in all, it is very manageable. I'm still salty that I didn't perform up to my potential in this course because I felt like I really understood what was taught but sold on the exams because I'm a nervous wreck and tend to blank out during them. Use the practice they give you (exams and quizzes dating back to the days where CS wasn't a 40,863 student per class major) and redo them till you can recognize the type of questions on the exam and can get instantly started on solving them. Also, Friday discussions were not it because wtf but they're worth it if you need the additional practice and sometimes you have to go because they give quizzes (they'll tell you when they are so don't worry). So go to discussion. Or don't.

Information	Review
Anwar Mamat CMSC330 ★★★★☆ Expecting a B Anonymous 05/20/2025	if you're trying to choose between anwar and cliff I wont lie there's not much of a difference whatsoever since they co teach. you can go to either lecture regardless of what u register for bc anwar got rid of his clicker quizzes. not sure about cliff but anwar doesn't use slides anymore to teach and personally it wasn't the best way for me to learn. exam 1 was pretty horrible for everyone, mean was around 65% or something but I'm sure they'll change it up for future semesters. the exams were pretty rough and the projects were hard because ocaml is really annoying but overall if you really lock in for the exams you should be ok since they give so much practice material.
Anwar Mamat CMSC330 ★★☆☆☆ Expecting an A- Anonymous 05/20/2025	i dont know why there are so many positive reviews for anwar, this guys teaching style is so boring to me. all he does in class is open up emacs and type up random examples all class; like sorry i just spaced out so much during lecture because who wants to watch some guy yap as he types up random notes for an hour and 15 minutes?? i wish he would bring back the slides and actually go over them in class because i have to spend the time in class listening to his lectures that dont make any sense and then spend extra time outside of class going over his slides and the mini quizzes in them since he doesn't. also he would like call on people randomly in class like if he thought certain people weren't paying attention which is like my worst nightmare. anyways it doesn't really matter who you take in this course but i would say to take cliff because hes younger and brings the vibes. he had better exam grades on average last semester but this semester anwars sections had higher grades so 🙄.
Anwar Mamat CMSC330 ★★★★★ Expecting an A- Anonymous 05/18/2025	Very good lecturer, recordings and slides posted, very nice person. Only complaint I could make would be the projects were on the harder side but if you start early you'll be totally fine. Exams were not bad at all and he has all of the old quizzes and exams on the class page. Overall I would definitely choose anwar again.
Cliff Bakalian CMSC330 ★★☆☆☆ Expecting an A Anonymous 05/17/2025	He mad the class way too hard because previous semesters people were cheating a lot, the exams were really hard, projects were fair, but challenging.
Katherine Saltzman CMSC330 ★★★★★ Anonymous 05/17/2025	Kat is hands down one of the best CMSC330 TAs. She is super kind and helpful and always has a smile on her face. Her positivity always puts me in a good mood. In office hours, she is very patient and explains concepts clearly. She is also a fun person to talk to about non-CS stuff. Overall rating: 5/5
Anwar Mamat CMSC330 ★★★★★ Expecting a B- Anonymous 05/10/2025	Dr. Mamat is a great instructor who genuinely cares about his students. He's very organized and always willing to help, whether it's during office hours or after class. He posts lecture recordings, which is super helpful, but I definitely recommend attending both lecture and discussion in person. While you can coast by without going, being there in person really makes a big difference in understanding the material and staying on track. He also makes an effort to get to know his students, which creates a more welcoming and engaging classroom environment. Overall, this class is well-structured and fair, and Professor Anwar does a great job supporting his students throughout. Highly recommend!
Anwar Mamat CMSC330 ★★★★☆ Expecting a C+ Anonymous 05/09/2025	Anwar was great, his lectures mostly involved typing coding examples to show how they worked which was the best way for me to learn the material. However, sometimes it's difficult to follow him when he either teaches another way or skips a couple of steps in his lectures. My biggest problem was that I felt really unprepared for most of the projects, especially Project 5, which was a complete nightmare made even more difficult this semester. But Anwar's funny, a very kind professor and genuinely cares about his students succeeding.

Information	Review
Cliff Bakalian CMSC330 ☆☆☆☆☆ Expecting a C Anonymous 05/05/2025	Pretty okay! Cliff and Anwar co-teach so you have both their lectures and their notes. Cliff's notes are really nice! But Anwar slides are goated. He has a slight accent but not really; you'll be fine. - 2 midterms. - 1 final. - 7 projects (all weighted differently). - 4 quizzes (during discussion). - 11? 12? lecture quizzes (you do them at home, not during lecture). PLEASE START PROJECT 5 EARLY PLEASSSEEEEEEEE E E EE
Cliff Bakalian CMSC330 ☆☆☆☆☆ Expecting a B+ Anonymous 05/04/2025	Cliffs lectures can be boring sometimes but overall, he's a good and fair professor. I would recommend anyone to take him. You will do well if you put in the effort. The first exam was wayyyyyyy worse than the second. The projects weren't too bad. Secret tests were annoying for some of them but you can easily get A's on most of the projects.
Anwar Mamat CMSC330 ☆☆☆☆☆ Expecting an A Anonymous 05/04/2025	Dr. Mamat is a great professor. He genuinely cares about his students and wants them to succeed, and he wants to cultivate a classroom environment where students feel comfortable and willing to ask questions. He is very good at tying complex concepts into real-life examples to make them more understandable. His exams were fair, and preparation for them helped me to understand the concepts better. However, I am not the biggest fan of Dr. Mamat's lecture style, I wish he would follow notes/slides a bit more strictly, as sometimes the concepts are a little difficult to follow when taking notes due to lack of clear structure. I also wish he would relate his lectures to the projects a little more, or at least be clearer with which aspects of the content would be on the projects. Many times it felt like I was learning the most from the projects, which isn't necessarily a bad thing, but still I wish that I was a little more prepared going into the projects. Still, he records all his lectures so if you ever feel lost you can go back and watch the recording. His class was tough but if you put in the work you will be fine. My breakdown of his exams/projects: Exam 1: hardest exam, average was a 67 Exam 2: harder content, but written to be easier than exam 1, average was a 78 Projects 1-2 weren't too bad. Projects 3 and 4 start to get more difficult. Project 5 was definitely the hardest. Project 6 was a breeze (intro to Rust). Project 7 TBD.
Anwar Mamat CMSC330 ☆☆☆☆☆ Expecting a B- Anonymous 05/02/2025	Guy with the review below is straight up lying lol, Anwar recorded and posted every single lecture video, found under Panopto Recordings in ELMS, I am really not sure why he is saying he didn't use lecture recordings.

Information	Review
Anwar Mamat CMSC330 ☆☆☆☆☆ Expecting an F Anonymous 04/17/2025	I didn't have the best experience with Dr. Mamat in CMSC330. While he clearly knows the material well, I found his lectures to be hard to follow and often disorganized. He would jump between code and slides without clearly connecting the concepts, which made it difficult to take notes or understand how everything fit together. It felt like he was more focused on getting through the material than making sure students were following along. He didn't use lecture recordings, which made it hard to review anything after class, especially for students who learn better by rewatching. I also thought the code demos, while sometimes helpful, were rushed and lacked thorough explanation. The projects were challenging, and while they were aligned with course content, there wasn't much support beyond office hours, which filled up fast. There were also times where project specs felt vague or assumed knowledge we hadn't really covered in lecture yet. The exams were fair, but since most of the emphasis was on the projects, you didn't get much feedback on how well you were doing until it was too late to make major improvements. Overall, I think the class could benefit from clearer organization, better pacing in lectures, and more structured support for the assignments. I wouldn't recommend taking CMSC330 with Dr. Mamat unless you're really confident learning independently.
Nitin Enjamuri CMSC330 ★★★★★ Expecting an A- Anonymous 04/09/2025	To the legend himself, Nitin Enjamuri — TA supreme of OCaml and all things CFG, lexer, parser, opsem, and interpreter wizardry. The way you break down abstract syntax trees? Literal poetry. Your ability to untangle eval semantics? Michelin-star level. Every whiteboard session feels like watching an artist at work — except the medium is functional programming and the vibes are immaculate. You don't just teach — you radiate understanding. You're like the monad that binds our confusion to clarity. The fixed point of our chaotic recursion. The reason our mental stacks don't overflow. OpSem bows to Nitin. And let's be honest: on top of the brilliant brain and heartwarming enthusiasm... you're criminally cute. Like, it's actually OP. The parse prince - Nerf Nitin when?
Katherine Saltzman CMSC330 ★★★★★ Expecting an A Anonymous 04/02/2025	Best 330 TA. She has a great sense of humor and is very knowledgeable on all of the topics covered in the course.
Alan Liu CMSC330 ★★★★★ Expecting an A+ Anonymous 03/26/2025	I would have failed without this man. Great TA. Thanks TA Alan!
Cliff Bakalian CMSC330 ★★★★☆ Expecting an A+ Anonymous 02/06/2025	Cliff's lectures were kind of pointless. Between his notes, the lecture quizzes/projects, the discussions (which also honestly weren't too helpful), and the online documentation for OCaml and Rust, I don't think Cliff's lectures really provided that much more value. I think Cliff should strongly consider doing a flipped classroom. I think that would be a much better use of lecture time.
Cliff Bakalian CMSC330 ★★★★☆ Expecting a C Anonymous 01/27/2025	Was okay, just do the work and pay attention, midterms were somewhat similar and the concepts are taught to the same degree.

Information	Review
Cliff Bakalian CMSC330 ☆☆☆☆☆ Expecting an A Anonymous 01/27/2025	sometimes i called him clifford baka Pros: Class overall is not as bad as the horror stories suggest Projects were interesting He's funny Exams were fair Cons: It was kinda funny how no one paid attention in lecture, he's not terrible but he's very monotone and it does get hard to pay attention Some of the projects were BRUTAL but looking back kinda straightforward, def go to office hours if you can snag a TA they are helpful Overall, you'll be fine, go to office hours
Cliff Bakalian CMSC330 ☆☆☆☆☆ Expecting an A Anonymous 01/25/2025	TL;DR: Just take Cliff for 330 Pros: - The exams and quizzes were very similar in nature to the practice exams and quizzes we were given, and there were a TON of resources to study with, so I never really felt unprepared going into an exam or quiz. - We had a decent amount of time to complete projects, and there we were also given three 24 hour late tokens that we could use as extensions on the projects, so that was helpful. - Cliff has incredibly thorough notes to help with learning stuff for the projects, quizzes and exams. Cons: - Cliff's teaching style is not for most people. Lectures can feel disorganized and it's really easy to lose interest quickly. Most of my friends and I just learned the material by reading his and Anwar's notes, and doing the projects.
Cliff Bakalian CMSC330 ☆☆☆☆ Expecting a D+ Anonymous 01/07/2025	Cliff is very hard to reach at times when you are trying to schedule office hours, barely interacts with the class during his lectures and worst of all he does not curve. If you take him, I recommend doing your best to get the percentage of the grade you want because he will not help you curve to the next letter grade. You're basically on your own. The quizzes were questionable in terms of difficulty, and his lectures barely covered them.
Cliff Bakalian CMSC330 ☆☆☆☆☆ Expecting an A Anonymous 12/30/2024	cliff is honestly a pretty good lecturer, all things considered. his quizzes tend to be on the tougher side, but his exams are all very fair. his projects were confusing to start due to the instructions providing little guidance, but i enjoyed them since they related back to the content we were learning in class (and as a result, strengthened my understanding of the content in the class). imo, he's decent at explaining concepts, but his public speaking skills are a little weak and as such, he talks very monotonously and his lectures feel more like he's talking to himself than to the class. that being said, he's also very funny, but he delivers his jokes in the same monotonous tone as the rest of his lecture so unless you're paying attention, you won't notice them. my main two complaints regarding the class were (1) i felt as if rust was not taught well because he only went over the theory of what makes rust different from other programming languages and the two rust projects were honestly free-for-alls, and (2) because of the content of the class changing frequently, studying from previous exams can only help so much. all in all though, i definitely enjoyed cliff's class and i think he's a solid professor for 330, and would be willing to take a class with him again. that being said, i believe that anwar has similar reviews to cliff and since they co-teach, my advice for choosing between the two is to first pick whoever works better for your schedule, and if they both work well, then choose cliff
Anwar Mamat CMSC330 ☆☆☆☆☆ Expecting an A+ Anonymous 12/25/2024	Solid professor. Teaching seemed more oriented to the projects, while the notes from Cliff (co-teaching this class with him) helped more with exams. Sometimes was a bit disorganized when going through slides. Code demos were good. The grading was 40% projects, so very generous in terms of exam weight.

Information	Review
Cliff Bakalian CMSC330 ☆☆☆☆☆ Expecting an A+ Anonymous 12/24/2024	First, I'm just going to start by saying, for CMSC330, it really doesn't matter much who your professor is. The lecture quizzes, projects, discussion content, TAs, quizzes, and exam content are all exactly the same. The only difference between Cliff and Anwar's sections are which professor's lecture you can attend, but even then, you can just not go to lecture or go to the other professor's lecture (some people found that they didn't really like Cliff's lectures and attended Anwar's instead---the class is big enough that I don't think people would notice). Unlike CMSC351, the professor doesn't make that much of a difference for this class, so don't freak out too much. That being said, I do think Dr. Mamat has the better slides and also more experience in the field, so if you do have a choice, I would probably choose him. Here are my comments on the course in general (this applies for both Dr. Mamat and Cliff's sections): - All the class information is available here: https://bakalian.cs.umd.edu/330 - Literally 44% of your grade is free. Why do I say this? Projects make up 40% of your grade and you get around two weeks for each of them (give or take). You can ask questions, ask the TAs, look up documentation, submit as many times as you want, etc. within those two weeks. Each project took me between two and eight hours. There is literally no reason not to get 100% on every project as long as you don't procrastinate. The median on every project was between 97% to 100%. So again, there's literally no reason not to get 100% on every project, and they make up 40% of your grade. - 4% of your grade is lecture quizzes, which are completely open internet. You can run the code on your own machine, and the lowest couple of lecture quizzes get dropped. So between the lecture quizzes and the projects, 44% of your grade should be completely free (as long as you don't procrastinate). - The quiz medians were: Quiz 1: 14.5/20, Quiz 2: 15/20, Quiz 3: 17.25/20, Quiz 4: 16/20. You get access to all of the course's quizzes and solutions from previous semesters, which is helpful for studying. I honestly found the quizzes to be harder than the midterms. I will say, though, that I didn't do very well on the first two quizzes, but after that, I started buckling down and really studying and I got 100s on the last two quizzes. You'll be fine as long as you study and really understand the content. - 46% of your grade is two midterms and the final. The medians were: Midterm 1: 83, Midterm 2: 87.5, Final (with extra credit): 89.48. Just like the quizzes, you get access to every previous midterm and their answer key, and around ~85% of the content on these exams is the same every semester. They do change things up a bit sometimes (like I think we did more garbage collection than they did in previous semesters), but most of the exams cover very similar content to previous semesters, so it's really helpful to take previous exams for practice. And yes, there's extra credit too. - The discussions were fine. I didn't find them too helpful. There were good review questions, but they were all in a publicly-available GitHub repository that you could look at without going to discussion. Honestly, unless you're really confused about something, you can usually just look up your question online or on Piazza. There are a gazillion resources out there for Ocaml and Rust. For Cliff in particular, I thought his lectures are okay. He goes at a very manageable pace; definitely not fast by any means. He can get pretty theoretical sometimes. He answers questions well. TLDR; This is a fairly easy class as long as you don't procrastinate on your projects and do previous quizzes/exams as practice. I would recommend not starting the projects any later than the weekend before they're due. You could definitely knock them out over the weekend (if you don't mind working on the weekends). I thought the content was fairly interesting, although obviously that's extremely subjective and is up to how interested you are in this type of stuff. I would recommend taking Dr. Mamat but it really doesn't matter that much.
Anwar Mamat CMSC330 ☆☆☆☆☆ Expecting a C+ Anonymous 12/23/2024	Anwar is a pretty good professor, he keeps his class fun and engaging and he's a pretty nice guy. He spends most of lecture typing code, which I think was nice but also made it a little difficult for me to take organized and helpful notes that I could actually use later. I would definitely recommend taking notes in a google doc or something on your laptop where you can type so that you can actually keep up with everything he's saying/writing. Projects were fairly difficult but that's CS for ya. Also, exams were actually weighted relatively lightly compared to projects (each midterm was 12% of your grade and there were multiple projects worth 8% of your grade each). Overall, I would say that Anwar is a pretty solid choice for 330.

Information	Review
Cliff Bakalian CMSC330 ☆☆☆☆☆ Expecting an A Anonymous 12/20/2024	im just gonna say that i don't think that cliff is a bad professor in terms of exams and quizzes. everything was super fair and as long as you understood what was happening in class, you were fairly fine. that being said, i'm not sure if im fully convinced that he's a good lecturer. i went to every lecture and tried to pay attention, but a lot of times it seemed like he was just talking to himself. i also didn't really like the format of his slides since when i was going through them on my own time, if i hit the wrong key i'd end up like four slides ahead. i really liked his notes, though, and they really helped during projects (which are very cool btw!!). overall, i think you're eventually going to have to end up self-studying most of the content (especially rust), but he's not a bad professor to take.
Cliff Bakalian CMSC330 ☆☆☆☆☆ Expecting an A Anonymous 12/20/2024	To sum things up concisely, the topics covered in this class aren't bad, but Cliff's lecturing style hurts overall engagement. I could not attend an entire lecture without sleeping or doing other work. Most of my productive learning came from reading Anwar's slides and Cliff's notes and starting the projects early. Exams, on the other hand, were pretty chill. They were very similar to past semester exams posted on the website. The quizzes were meh. As many others have mentioned, the first quiz is generally the worst. After we took the first quiz, my TA said, "Congrats, guys. The first quiz historically has a D average." Don't panic about the first one; the others are much better. Overall, three stars for many opportunities to help your grade/do well. Minus two stars for Cliff's lecture engagement.
Anwar Mamat CMSC330 ☆☆☆☆☆ Expecting a B+ Anonymous 12/20/2024	For the Fall 2024 semester, Dr Mamat and Cliff cotaught using Cliffs resources, course organization, and exam styles. Dr Mamat got rid of the clicker quizzes our semester and stopped recording lectures, which I didn't mind because I went to almost every lecture. Dr Mamat was funny, but his lectures tended to be disorganized. I found them to be very intuitive when he was typing examples into emacs, but he was flipping through his slides, I felt lost. The projects are hard but they teach you the content very well. The exams are fair. Overall, Dr Mamat is a solid choice for this class.
Anwar Mamat CMSC330 ☆☆☆☆☆ Expecting an A homework420 12/20/2024	I really liked the class, Anwar is super fun and engaging even if the content can be kind of boring at times. He doesn't do clicker quizzes anymore and now its lecture quizzes that you can do in groups that are assigned over the weekends (they're basically a free 100). There is also a lot of extra credit, 1% for participating in discussion, and 1% if 90% of students do the course evals at the end of the semester. Projects are also worth almost half of your total grade which is great cause it makes it a lot easier to get a good great. I got a 70 on the first exam and still ended up with an A because of all the stuff I just mentioned. If you're choosing between cliff and anwar it won't really matter too much, both are decent teachers
Cliff Bakalian CMSC330 ☆☆☆☆☆ Expecting an A+ Anonymous 12/19/2024	DO NOT WORRY ABT THIS CLASS Cliff is my goat. Yes, sometimes lectures can be a bit messy, but he's really good at explaining things one-on-one AND his notes are fantastic. If going to lecture isn't doing it for you, I suggest going through his notes instead. Projects are actually great, and complement/reinforce what was covered in lecture. Finally, he provides basically every quiz or exam for the class from the past 5 years, and assessments this semester were always similar to those in the past. So, grind those past quizzes and exams and you'll be chilling. And if that wasn't enough, he gave us 2% extra credit for basically free (filling out the course eval survey and attending discussion). The 75th percentile was a 95. That means more than 25% of people got an A. You do not have to worry about 330 if you're taking it with Cliff. Just sit back and enjoy learning without stressing about your grades!

Information	Review
Cliff Bakalian CMSC330 ☆☆☆☆☆ Expecting an A- Anonymous 12/19/2024	Lectures are terrible, but I highly recommend attending Anwar's lectures. The material covered in class is often straightforward, but he tends to overcomplicate it and deliver ineffective lectures. When he taught a concept like "NFA to DFA," I realized I wouldn't be attending his lectures anymore. The TAs, on the other hand, do a much better job explaining topics. They use a table-based approach for concepts like NFA to DFA, making it simple to understand. Unfortunately, Cliff skips such practical explanations and complicates the material unnecessarily. While it might seem easy to grasp once you already understand the topic, he doesn't adequately cover the basics, which is crucial for students learning it for the first time. The 330 projects were often quite challenging, but I understood their importance since it's a project-based class, and I was okay with that. However, if you're trying to learn effectively, I strongly advise avoiding Cliff and opting for Anwar instead. They also offered a 2% grade boost if you completed the course evaluation and attended at least eight discussions, which was a nice. Additionally, my discussion section leader was extremely helpful. They covered critical topics that were essential for quizzes and midterms, so I recommend attending those sessions. Some of the coding questions from previous finals were ridiculously difficult, almost as challenging as the projects. However, in Fall 2024, we got lucky, as the difficulty seemed more reasonable.
Cliff Bakalian CMSC330 ☆☆☆☆☆ Expecting an A Anonymous 12/16/2024	This course was co-taught this semester with Anwar Mamat, but Cliff was okay as a teacher. His teaching didn't work for me, perhaps because he often doesn't explain how things connect too well or motivate the topics we're doing in class. Often, I'd feel more confused about a topic after hearing Cliff explain it in a lecture. Thus, after finding lectures futile, I just used the posted slides and notes, which proved to be more helpful. For logistics, he gives weekly take-home quizzes, which are meant to be collaborative—but they can basically just be seen as forced studying material, or like homework. Moreover, he gives four quizzes throughout the semester, which take place in discussion and are good for forcing us to study material, aside from exams. The exams were pretty fair, admittedly they were probably easier than they could've been (which I appreciate). The Final, however, I found pretty challenging overall. Ultimately, this class is quite confusing and Cliff didn't ever really help clear any ambiguity of this sort, but if you can learn the material through the slides or notes then it's rather easy from there.
Cliff Bakalian CMSC330 ☆☆☆☆☆ Expecting an A Anonymous 12/11/2024	He's a cool professor. Average at lecturing and boring at times but he'll crack jokes and answer student's questions very well. The course content itself is boring. Probably the most boring CS class I've taken (but not Cliff's fault lol). Medium difficulty and easier than 216 IMO. I'd recommend taking cliff and think his more recent reviews reflect him better than the old ones. Seemed like he wasn't too good at lecturing as a fresh grad I guess, but he worked out the kinks from his previous course mishaps and lecturing style. Also lectures are not recorded but his slides are detailed and he gives a ton of extra practice. There's easy weekly lecture quizzes, and he posts all the previous semester's exams and quizzes so there's a TON of study material.
Cliff Bakalian CMSC330 ☆☆☆☆☆ Expecting an A- Anonymous 12/09/2024	First, the cons, which is mainly one thing: - His lecturing style did NOT work for me. It's pretty disorganized, and though I pretty much stopped going to class altogether after about a month, I didn't often walk out of class with a good sense of what had just been taught. The lecture slides are kind of all over the place and skim the concepts very quickly, and the he just kind of freehands examples in VIM. You can tell during lecture that the class is pretty disengaged. HOWEVER, there are a lot of things that I appreciated about Cliff's class! He was co-teaching with Anwar, and I heard similar complaints about his lectures from other people. To be honest, I ended up mainly just self-teaching, which I've never done before honestly, and reading Cliff's notes (which are great, READ THEM if you don't want to get tripped up on T/F questions) and Anwar's slides before quizzes/exams. It worked out okay for me, but I don't know if I'd be excited to do it again. The projects are pretty challenging and time consuming, but they leave you with a great understanding of the material. In addition to just studying before tests, I think that the projects did a lot of the teaching for me in this class. There are extensive review materials before the midterms and the midterms enjoyably employed an extremely similar structure to Spring 2024, so they were super doable. Quizzes were hit or miss but oh well.

Information	Review
Cliff Bakalian CMSC330 ☆☆☆☆☆ Expecting an A Anonymous 12/08/2024	I'm not sure why Cliff has low-ish reviews. I guess that CS students love complaining that the professors whose lectures they don't attend are bad at teaching. I'll start with the bad, because honestly, there is not that much. Firstly, he doesn't post his notes on time. Most of the time, his notes are posted days after the lecture went over them, which can be quite annoying for those who like to review notes before or after lectures. Secondly, he's somewhat disorganized when teaching, and his in-class reviews and examples are all over the place. Other than that, he's an amazing professor. He has plenty of review material for both quizzes and exams, and has practice utilities. The exams and quizzes are also very fair. Some of the projects can be tedious, but he gives ample time for students to complete the projects, which are integrated very well into the material that is taught. Overall, a pretty good professor.
Cliff Bakalian CMSC330 ☆☆☆☆☆ Expecting an A Anonymous 12/06/2024	Pros: - The lectures were informative, substantive with both slideshows and coding demos. I thought discussions were a great way to practice the material. - The interactive exercises that TAs and the professors coded that were listed on the class website were great (e.g., lambda calculus, nfa to dfa). - The practice exams and quizzes were also very helpful. - The lecture quizzes and discussion quizzes also made sure I was prepared. - The projects also were generally very good, especially making me think with the secret tests - TAs are very very helpful at helping me think about the problem and push me in the right direction without giving me the answer, and just explaining concepts in general. - Office hours are very efficient. He uses Quuly which is an app for managing office hours without needing a whiteboard or just trying to figure out who's a TA and who's a student. It tells you the expected wait time and options for both virtual and in-person office hours. I would highly recommend going to office hours on days other than the 2 days before the project, because then you'll get attention almost immediately. Basically the course is very well-structured, grading is very fair, content is very interesting and valuable, course load is very manageable for a hard-working student, and lectures are self-contained (meaning you don't really need to learn the content outside the class). You won't go wrong with Cliff, he's a great lecturer, runs a great class, and I would highly recommend. That said, this was my hardest class of the semester and the most significant amount of time. But that's just me. Cons: - Personally, I thought Cliff's public speaking needs improvement. He paces and has lots of vocal fillers. Sometimes he talks in a tone that makes him sound bored or frustrated. But none of this actually matters. - Sometimes he runs into errors during his coding demos in lecture and wastes time debugging which he should have done before lecture. I think it's unprofessional - Most of the time when I failed a test in a project it was because the project instructions didn't specify what I needed to do in that case, so I had to go to office hours to figure it out. But that didn't take much time. - Too many times he finished lecture early. I think if I added all of that time together, we could have fit in at least 1 or 2 more lectures with more content. I am strongly opposed to classes ending earlier than the schedule.
Minsi Hu CMSC330 ☆☆☆☆☆ Expecting an A Anonymous 12/03/2024	Without Minsi, I don't think I would have passed this course. Minsi was the GOAT, and I always looked forward to his discussion every week. Whether it's NFA, DFA, regex, Minsi knows it all.
Cliff Bakalian CMSC330 ☆☆☆☆☆ Anonymous 11/18/2024	He's a great professor. He's really lenient with extensions which is something I myself have appreciated with; he is reasonable with course requirements. Definitely take.

Information	Review
Cliff Bakalian CMSC330 ★★★★★ Expecting an A+ Anonymous 10/04/2024	5 stars because even though lectures weren't really my style, they were informative and covered the material well, and anything else you need is in his posted notes. The main thing I disliked was his use of typing things into a REPL and explaining using that instead of pre-preparing notes and going over them with us - the same info was gotten, but it was much harder to take live notes effectively, and led to some errors in lecture. I went to his office hours once and he personally and patiently explained a concept to me until I understood, which was nice. He also co-teaches with the other prof each semester, so if you hate his teaching style you can just use the other prof's notes. Exams and quizzes are odd for me to review. In my semester, I found them very easy. I checked out a friend's exam when she got it back and they look a bit harder now, though quizzes look the same. However, the profs generally share exams/quizzes so this isn't really a big thing to choose Cliff/not choose Cliff. I was in the class with the 11.5 average (/20) quiz1, and got almost full points - the main issue was that it focused a lot on a small concept (the one that he explained to me one-on-one, actually), so anyone who wasn't comfortable with that was a bit screwed. However, he gives full copies with answers for all past semester quizzes, so it was clear that this concept was important and you had material to study for it with. The topics are very conceptual. I think this class is like an "intro to compilers" more than anything else. They introduce a lot of concepts that aren't super useful on their own but could turn out useful if you do research or language development, especially. There are also a few small things that are useful (intro to git, use of map/reduce(fold), PBT, regex) in general coding work as well. Overall okay class, enjoyed it with Cliff.
Anwar Mamat CMSC330 ★★★★☆ Expecting an A- Anonymous 08/15/2024	Solid professor, really enjoyed CMSC 330 with him. He's also pretty funny lol. He gives you a lot of material to work from and excellent advice. Clicker quizzes are good, it helps with understanding material in real time.
Anwar Mamat CMSC330 ★★★★★ Expecting an A+ Anonymous 06/11/2024	He is a kind person that really cares about how you're doing. You gotta be quick with your fingers if you wanna be able to answer all the clicker questions. The amount of times I missed a clicker was so many :(
Anwar Mamat CMSC330 ★★★★☆ Expecting a B Anonymous 05/29/2024	Anwar's lectures can be dry and boring at times, but he is a good teacher. You can not ask for a more qualified professor who is an expert in the field for CMSC330. Extremely intelligent and funny at times, but tries to avoid joking around too much as 330 has a lot of content. 330 is hard and the projects took me a long time personally, but you can not go wrong with Anwar. Between Cliff and Anwar, I would lean Anwar's way since he has much more experience in the field.
Anwar Mamat CMSC330 ★★★★☆ Expecting a B+ Anonymous 05/28/2024	He's a great public speaker I think the first half of the semester he was getting back into teacher but after that he was getting better at lecturing. He does clicker quizzes which to be honest only people who don't want to show up to lecture complain about it's a free 4% of your entire grade he essentially gives people answers to it most of the time and there not hard questions. As for projects, exams, and quizzes he co taught with Cliff so most of the projects and exams were made by Cliff and his TAs from my understanding. Between Cliff or him Anwar is the better 330 professor provides great slides to study off and is more entertaining/easier to follow.
Cliff Bakalian CMSC330 ★★★★★ Expecting an A Anonymous 05/28/2024	CS 330, a hard class they say, But I never did much work anyways They groan and they sweat and sometimes they cry But to that I say "I didn't even have to try" Speaking seriously, Cliff's 330 is a great class and not very difficult. You'll learn a lot from his projects. Take him!

Information	Review
Cliff Bakalian CMSC330 ☆☆☆☆☆ Expecting an A- Anonymous 05/22/2024	Loved the class, very little busy work, intentful projects, fair exams. There are once a week lecture quizzes where you can collaborate with people so it's not hard to get a good grade on those and they act as a little grade boost. He and anwar gave extra credit that was max 1% that came from discussion attendance/participation. I never went to discussion so I didn't really get those points but it's easy to get those. He also gave 1% if 90% of your section did the course evals at the end of the semester. The projects to take a while but I really liked them. Just make sure to start them early so you're not working for 12 hours straight for 3 days in a row like me. The 4 quizzes throughout the semester were kinda hard but not too bad if you studied. The biggest complaint was about the final this semester. The general consensus was that it was really hard(I studied a while so I did alright) but the average was 68 and he did not curve it. One other issue was the handling of exam 1. I was in a section that had a fire alarm go off right before we took the exam so ours got postponed two days. This was fine but our lecture's exam average/median were about 10% under the other classes. But, at the end of the semester, I only got a 5% boost on that exam, so I think they either curved it on a bell curve or just didn't curve it as much as I think they should have. This probably won't happen again so thats not really an issue in the future but just something to note.
Anwar Mamat CMSC330 ☆☆☆☆☆ Expecting a C- Anonymous 05/22/2024	Great professor, he gives a lot of useful info during lectures and he's the one who will believe in you. He'll give you a chance, like an extension (it never hurts to ask if you really need it)! and he will help you success in his course
Alan Liu CMSC330 ☆☆☆☆☆ Expecting an A+ Anonymous 05/21/2024	Love this man, super smiley, brings chocolate into discussion, we refer to him as TA ALAN. WE LOVE TA ALAN
Anwar Mamat CMSC330 ☆☆☆☆☆ Expecting a B Anonymous 05/21/2024	He goes super fast through the content which is very jarring for the first few lectures, so trying to take notes is impossible. But, his slides are very good so there's no need to in my opinion. He has clicker quizzes during lectures to keep people engaged and make attendance mandatory, but they're never too bad and they do help with the content. 330 is the hardest CS class I've taken so far, and it's because all of the content is new. Exams are usually fair but hard, and the project take a very long time to complete. The best thing about Anwar is his passion for teaching. He came back from AWS to teach and I can see why, and I'm glad he did.
Anwar Mamat CMSC330 ☆☆☆☆☆ Expecting an A- Anonymous 05/20/2024	Not sure what the person below says hes not a good lecturer for, cause he is really great and makes class interesting, way better than Cliff and more engaging. We had Cliff sub in for Anwar which I am just falling a asleep. The powerpoint slides are great and very informative. A lot of projects with short deadlines, but willing to give extensions which are nice. Lecture quizzes makes you pay attention in class. Regular discussion quizzes were hit or miss. Exams are fair. One bad side is some of his lectures are very boring which are mainly the useless ones.
Anwar Mamat CMSC330 ☆☆☆☆☆ Expecting a B+ Anonymous 05/20/2024	Dude explained most of the concepts fairly well but for some topics, he kind of just speedran through the slides. Overall, Anwar was co teaching with cliff so we had the same, quizzes, exams, projects but Anwar had in class clicker quizzes while Cliff had separate lecture quizzes for his students of which 20 percent was dropped for both instructors. Overall, Anwar was much more refreshing compared to 216 with herman and his slides were super helpful for the projects and in addition for some projects he also give some tips or boilerplate code to help students get started with some functions whichw as super helpful. Exams were super fair but make sure to prepare for the final since it was definitely harder than the midterms. I kind of went straight into the exam without studying at all which backfired since it was much harder so I got a 70 which dropped my overall grade from a 93 to an 88.

Information	Review
Anwar Mamat CMSC330 ☆☆☆☆☆ Expecting an A- Anonymous 05/20/2024	He's really nice and funny, he spent an entire lecture basically giving a standup comedy session which was great. He is also really caring and offers students many ways to succeed. As a lecturer, he is not the best. Hard to follow/understand at times and can rush through slides. Clicker quizzes can also be annoying since lectures are recorded but still cannot be skipped in-person since they are worth 4% of your grade. Projects are interesting but some can be poorly written. Mostly fair exams, though our final had an average of like 68%. Cliff gave a lecture one time while Dr. Mamat was out, and he was definitely a better lecturer. Cannot speak about how he is on the administrative/personal side of things, where Dr. Mamat mostly excels in.
Anwar Mamat CMSC330 ☆☆☆☆☆ Expecting a B+ Anonymous 05/20/2024	have seen way worse but honestly just not a good lecturer at all either. first time you'll cover a concept sometimes will be on a quiz where its just a guessing game at that point. lectures are super fast paced so you dont learn anything and theyre also hella boring. doesnt explain anything he just glosses over stuff at best.
Cliff Bakalian CMSC330 ☆☆☆☆☆ Expecting an A+ Anonymous 05/19/2024	Clippy? More like Cliffy. Cliff is honestly a pretty great lecturer in my opinion, despite what I came in thinking. Although all of his lectures are mostly him typing in VIM, so it's pretty hard to take structured notes, I think he explains topics quite well, and his notes on the 330 website are pretty great and do much more than what's needed. Tests are really fair, though sometimes some questions are a bit tricky (nowhere near as bad as something like a Yoon question though lol). Quizzes are honestly kind of easy to mess up from my experience, but there's only 4 of them and they only make up 10% of the grade. I will say my main strike against this class is the fact that it's pretty disorganized at many points. This comes up in many ways, but just one of them is the fact that projects and their descriptions could be quite unclear. I also wish Piazza was a tiny bit more responsive: sometimes there were questions we really wanted to have answered, but they were sorta delayed. But really, I'll be honest, Cliff was honestly a pretty nice experience. Would give 4.5 stars if I could :)
Anwar Mamat CMSC330 ☆☆☆☆☆ Anonymous 05/19/2024	Don't get me wrong, Anwar seems like a genuinely nice and intelligent guy. That being said, he is one of the worst computer science professors I've had at UMD. CMSC 330 by itself is notoriously disorganized. They seem to change the syllabus and languages covered every semester, never seeming quite certain about what they are going to do over the 15 weeks and jolting around during lectures. Everything is so haphazard and nothing is properly communicated. There are four quizzes during the lecture and they always cover content that was poorly taught during the lectures that happened that week specifically. There is rarely any time given to actually absorb the content before the quizzes. Projects vary, some being hard and others much easier. Most of the projects will have to be self study because they barely cover what we need to know for them during lecture. Anwar himself is a poor lecturer. He zooms through slides and is always flipping between a powerpoint and a terminal or just freeballing and using his web browser. Because of this it never seems like he has a solid idea of what he's trying to cover during the lecture. The resources given to us are also super messy. I feel like 1/3 of the content we need to know is actually taught and the other 2/3 are scattered across random GIT repositories, massive slide decks that are only half covered in class, or other notes. You will feel lost and alone in the course and there is no one really to help you except your friends who are taking it too. The exams oscillated between very fair and very challenging, with some questions seeming near impossible to finish. Cliff doesn't seem much better and they co-teach the course so good luck to any soldier who has to take it. I very much hope the entire department wakes up and realizes that this is their worst course, but seeing how these problems have persisted for the last 5+ years I highly doubt it.
Anwar Mamat CMSC330 ☆☆☆☆☆ Anonymous 05/18/2024	Anwar was great! He's a pretty funny guy, so I though his lectures were always fairly entertaining, but he does go kinda fast sometimes. He has in class clicker questions, which are a part of your grade, so going to lecture is kinda required. We had 7 projects throughout the semester, most of which I thought were pretty difficult, but if you started early on them, you'd be fine. 2 midterms and a final, which were all pretty easy and similar to the practice exams. We also had 4 discussion quizzes throughout the semester, which were also not that bad. Overall, I definitely recommend taking this class with Anwar!

Information	Review
Cliff Bakalian CMSC330 ★★★★★ Expecting an A Anonymous 05/17/2024	Cliff runs the most organized class I've taken at UMD. Exams, projects, and quizzes were all fair, and I didn't have any major complaints. His lectures are a bit boring, and his slides are practically useless, but his notes are really good. You should be aware that projects are modified/made from scratch during the semester, so some projects will have important clarifications after their release and the auto-grader is often released well after the project is. I'd definitely recommend taking him.
Anwar Mamat CMSC330 ★★★★★ Expecting an A Anonymous 05/17/2024	Anwar is a great lecturer and funny guy. However, very similar to Nelson in that he annoys some people because he sometimes takes time out of lecture to tell a funny story(something I personally love). This was not ideal since he was coteaching and would sometimes have to speedrun to catch up to Cliff's class but imo it was worth it. Early on in the semester it was a little rough because it was his first time teaching after a couple years working, but once he got into it I really learned a lot. Projects were long but usually 2-3 weeks were given for them so if you actually started within a few days of them being assigned you could get them done pretty easily. He also gives some sample code that is very similar to the project. We had either a quiz or exam every two weeks which was really nice because it kept me accountable for the material and studying for any exam wasn't that hard because I only had to study like two weeks of content(assuming I remembered everything).
Cliff Bakalian CMSC330 ★★★★★ Expecting an A+ Anonymous 05/15/2024	It was a good class. It was well taught and organized, and his notes were very good if you missed something in the lecture. The projects were all alright, although there is room for improvement with some (which will happen, as this was just after a major restructuring of the course). His Rust knowledge was a little spotty, though.
Cliff Bakalian CMSC330 ★★★★☆ Expecting a B Anonymous 05/14/2024	interesting class. cliff is cool. lectures could be better, but overall I enjoyed it.
Cliff Bakalian CMSC330 ★★★★★ Expecting an A- Anonymous 05/10/2024	I LOVE THIS MAN. He started off the first lecture saying something like "welcome to the best course in the cs department" and ngl looking back, he was not lying. I consistently sat in the first two rows (as was advised by friends who took 330 w Cliff in past semesters) which helped tremendously. I really like the course material too. There was a lot of interesting content that I feel would always use in my cs endeavors going forward. Quizzes were difficult, I consistently got 10-15/20 until the last quiz; they were difficult because the formatting kinda threw me off. Also, I'm such a fan of Rust that I'm sad we didn't get to use it a lot in this class. Some problems are that there are some lack of materials sometimes because of how much the course curriculum changes on a semesterly basis, but Anwar came in clutch by giving us the format for like exam 3 (?). Cliff sometimes goes a bit fast during his lectures, but sit in the front rows FOR REAL and you'll be an OCaml master in no time. Watch his cool hair flips and laugh at his snarky jokes. Yeah he's my favorite professor thus far.
Anjali Kumar CMSC330 ★★★★★ Expecting a B Anonymous 05/03/2024	Has cool laptop stickers!
Anwar Mamat CMSC330 ★★☆☆☆ Expecting a B Anonymous 03/12/2024	Anwar is not a good lecturer, the lectures are incredibly disengaging, and trying to take notes is hard as he flies through his slides. He yaps away while doing a poor job explaining new concepts, and if it were not for his in-lecture "clicker" quizzes, I would self-study because at least his online lecture slides at least contain everything he says, not to mention that he records. Cliff's notes are arguably more detailed and understandable though. I do give him credit for his extremely fair exams and grading, he seems to be generous with partial credit.

Information	Review
Cliff Bakalian CMSC330 ☆☆☆☆☆ Anonymous 03/05/2024	(A)nd shall I compare Cliff to a summer's day? (M)ethinks Cliff art more lovely and more temperate: (O), do Rough winds do shake the darling buds of May, (G)olly, and summer's lease hath all too short a date; (U)surp Sometime too hot the eye of heaven shines, (S)o often is his luscious majestic dark hair dimm'd; And every fair from fair sometime declines, (S)uch by chance or nature's changing course untrimm'd; (L)ore but thy eternal summer shall not fade, (A)nd nor lose possession of that clear Cliff ow'st; (Y)ap Nor shall death brag thou wander'st in his shade, (P)anic! When in eternal lines to time Cliff grow'st: So long as men can breathe or eyes can see, (bruh) So long lives this, and this gives life to Cliff. #[derive(Debug)] In all honesty, Cliff tries his best and cares about the academic success and wellbeing of his students. Thanks for a great somewhat chaotic semester!
Ceren Mert CMSC330 ☆☆☆☆☆ Anonymous 01/27/2024	Ceren is fantastic! Super down-to-earth, chill, and helpful in office hours. I'm lucky to have met her last semester!
Zoya Tasneem CMSC330 ☆☆☆☆☆ Anonymous 01/27/2024	Zoya is simply incredible! She is down-to-earth, so so helpful, and super funny too. I am so lucky to have met her last semester <3 thank you Zoya!
Vasu Mittal CMSC330 ☆☆☆☆☆ Anonymous 01/27/2024	Vasu is a fantastic TA - easily one of the best! He really goes above and beyond to break down and explain concepts clearly to students. He also is always very genuine and always down to share notes and such. You can tell he really cares about his students and their academic success. The GOAT
Cliff Bakalian CMSC330 ☆☆☆☆☆ Expecting an A+ Anonymous 01/14/2024	exams werent bad at all, quizzes were hit or miss, but just make sure to manage your time with projects. cliff is a pretty decent lecturer as well. overall felt like a breath of fresh air compared to larry herman's 216-- no style points, mostly public/release tests, exams weighted a lot less than projects, extra credit if you participate, late tokens, etc. 330's also much more skill-based than rote memorization. my one complaint was there was a project that was very poorly written in the beginning of the semester. it was a terrible time trying to figure out how to interpret it even with the extension. but, projects after that were much clearer.
Cliff Bakalian CMSC330 ☆☆☆☆☆ Expecting a B Anonymous 01/03/2024	average lecturer. he's not bad by any means, but not the best either. since lectures are so long, it can get very boring to the point where you don't want to attend. his exams are of medium difficulty. some projects are not that bad, but a few of them are terrible, almost to the point where you cant even do it at all. quizzes are not that bad.

Information	Review
Cliff Bakalian CMSC330 ☆☆☆☆☆ Expecting an A+ Anonymous 12/28/2023	He is a pretty decent lecturer and is pretty kind. However, the course is designed to be a lot of self-teaching. For example, we jump into projects with three different languages that we are unfamiliar with and are expected to teach ourselves the syntax and find different functions to use. The discussion sections are helpful, but the quizzes are hard and we are not given a lot of study material. The past exams and quizzes do not relate to how the class is structured now, so it is hard to prepare for them. They do curve most of the assignments, which is helpful if you bomb one or two assignments in each category.
Cliff Bakalian CMSC330 ☆☆☆☆☆ Expecting a B Anonymous 12/26/2023	this class has a lot in terms of work but it's not really too terrible in terms of difficulty. thought multiple times i was going to get like a 50 on a exam including the final but i was always surprised that i would score high 80s on them and it's not cus im goated and all that it's really just cus cliff is a decent teacher. Been a while since i saw B in a computer science class so yeah. Only few things sucked like quiz 1 and like 2 projects but it didn't really affect me in the overall grand scheme of the class and my grade since if you get 50 percent on those things it was like only 7 percent gone. i imagine he's going to learn from them as well to fix them and such. that being said, he could have small hiccups like those for future semesters and if youre a tryhard that might be an issue but cliff will sure try his best to accommodate to it if it happens. Overall i enjoyed having cliff as my teacher and i can definitely see him becoming a really good professor, dudes only like 25. his lectures were kind of boring tho but so is every professor i ever had except for justin
Anthony Gomes CMSC330 ☆☆☆☆☆ Expecting an A ant_g51 12/23/2023	Goat
Cliff Bakalian CMSC330 ☆☆☆☆☆ Expecting a B Anonymous 12/23/2023	Cliff is an ard professor in my opinion. Pros: good TAs fair exams and quizzes(except quiz 1) He tries his best to help the students Bonus points for participation Cons: boring lecturer does not record Some Difficult projects(Every CS coding class is going to have difficult projects so it is what it is) Overall this class was not that bad

Information	Review
Cliff Bakalian CMSC330 ☆☆☆☆ Expecting a B+ frankMiller 12/21/2023	Took CMSC330: Organization of Programming Languages with Cliff Bakalian in Fall 2023 (CS major requirement). 1.5 stars for this class, I reserve 1 star for Kruskal. Felt like Cliff really did not care about the well-being and success of his students in their own terms, only did what he wanted. e.g. he feels that uploading answers is beneficial so he will upload but he will not go out of his way on anything else. Maybe he's not expected to, but it makes you miss a teacher for Nelson for example. Everything is available on the class website, fortunately: https://bakalian.cs.umd.edu/330/resources Cliff runs one of the better-administered courses, but he can still mess up: project is released really close to finals with no prior communication, exams taking forever to grade. Entire class was so theoretical I am worried. It's the 300 levels; when do things begin to relate to the real world? Probably not Cliff's fault, but I need to go out there and build things that people will pay me for, not just convert NFAs to DFAs and learn about lambda calculus theory. Exams: I felt these were brutal. Felt like no amount of preparation would prepare me for them. Projects were also brutal, for the first time I found myself liberally using up late tokens. Often unreasonably difficult and only achievable with a lot of stress, time, tears, and assistance. Heavy workload. Cliff has both positive and negative marking, so the grading is all over the place and you are hit with heavy penalties that will obliterate your score. Another recent reviewer from my batch mentioned how the exams are easy but I found them very difficult, maybe it's just me. Absolutely terrible lectures, Cliff is notorious for them. No idea what is going on. I only went for the participation points and to stay abreast somewhat of what was happening but basically you have to learn yourself. Discussions are bad, but not the fault of the TA who was very nice (Amr Tairi). But I felt that what we did discussion was not so helpful. Don't even get me started on the office hours -- both the TA office hours and Cliff office hours. Cliff will actually help you, the problem is that he is spending one hour with the person who came before you even though there is a queue of six people. I got fed up and went just once. TA office hours were objectively THE WORST and a NIGHTMARE, and yes it is Cliff's fault because he is the boss of the TAs. He let them walk all over him and do a bad job. Don't tell me it's not Cliff's fault; Cliff has created a culture. TAs are consistently excellent under Nelson because he actually cares about his students. - Tiny, two desk open area swarming with people, filled with off-duty TAs who just use it as a place to hang out and have a good time amidst all the suffering. - Takes HOURS to get a TA, during non-peak hours (e.g. day after the project is due) who: - Looks down upon you like you are some kind of parasite wasting their time - Doesn't even try to understand what you are saying - Basically just says "I cannot give you the answer" when all you are asking for is some guidance

Information	Review
	- Not only does not help, but gives you the WRONG answer - Spends five minutes with you and leaves. It was truly terrible. Frankly I've heard Kauffman teaches well, but everything else he does the same with Cliff. So maybe just take Kauffman and benefit from Cliff resources? I don't know, check out his reviews.
Christopher Kauffman CMSC330 ★★★★★ Anonymous 12/21/2023	From my course eval: "Professor Kauffman's lectures were extremely helpful in understanding the material and I appreciated the amount of time he spent going over concepts and the depth at which he covered them. His in-class activities were a breath of fresh air after previous lecture-heavy CS courses and helped solidify concepts. He answered questions during class thoroughly and was clearly passionate about the material and about his students' success. His slides were both informative and visually appealing (as a hobbyist graphic designer, I approve). His nerdy lecture examples were memorable (I recall a Lord of the Rings-themed one demonstrating OCaml records). When extenuating circumstances arose, he was quick to respond to emails and quick to be accommodating. He was extremely open to feedback and willing to sit down in office hours with his students discussing said feedback at length. I do not think I could have had a better 330 professor than him, and I will be looking forward to taking future courses with him (if possible)."
Christopher Kauffman CMSC330 ★★★★★ Expecting a B ibrahim 12/21/2023	Incredible Professor, definitely the best CS professor I've ever had, and he makes it a point to answer everyones question and make sure the class understands topics at a high level. Study the material in class and practice on your own with all the examples he provides in slides and discussions as well as actually understanding the projects, you'll be fine
Cliff Bakalian CMSC330 ★★★★☆ Expecting an A+ Anonymous 12/20/2023	Very nice guy. He has pretty decent notes on his website, and we also have a piazza which is fairly responsive. His lectures aren't the best (half the time he walks in with his xps and starts typing in vim), but they basically cover the same amount of stuff as his notes, which makes it tempting to skip class. The projects are mostly good, as well. Overall, not a bad professor. The course content carried hard, though, since I personally found it interesting and at times fun.
Christopher Kauffman CMSC330 ★★★★★ Expecting a C- Anonymous 12/20/2023	Kauffman is a great dude, and I really enjoyed his lectures. He was co-teaching with Cliff this semester, but his exams and quizzes were still fair and he owned up to when they were not. His lectures are super engaging and have good activities baked into them. Overall, 330 was not what I expected it to be - I thought it would be more of a software engineering course, but it was more the theory behind programming languages and deep exploration of functional programming (OCaml)

Information	Review
Cliff Bakalian CMSC330 ☆☆☆☆☆ Expecting an A+ Anonymous 12/20/2023	"AFAIK cliff is cringe. cliff, cringe jk idk is cringe" - CMSC330 Final Summer 2023 Cliff is kind of a middle of the road professor at this time. The biggest problems currently are the lack of good project documentation and poor administration. With the project documentation, even outside of the dreaded project 2, the README's consistently left out important information which I needed to scrub through Piazza to get. With administration, projects were pretty much developed on the spot as far as I'm aware, as the autograder was consistently released well after the project start date, and project 8 had a massive delay. Both of these factors make projects much more of a pain than they need to be, as development problems are more often something poorly/not addressed in the README rather than programming logic errors, and "semipublic" testing is delayed until the autograder is up. In addition, while ultimately minor, the lectures were honestly fairly boring and disorganized, as many of them are freeform coding/drawing sessions, but the coding particularly doesn't work because much of the time is spent on coding instead of getting across the main points. Finally, 20 minutes for the quizzes just feels too short, and 25/30 minutes seems far more reasonable for the assessments they are. For the good, besides the project 8 fiasco, the TAs, Cliff, and Kauffman were all fairly active in responding to Piazza inquiries. Most of the projects themselves, except for the infamous project 2, have all boiled down to reasonable implementations. The lecture quizzes were fairly useful, and the amount of forgiveness on them was really nice (I missed one by accident and still got full credit for lecture quizzes). Exam weighting made exams not overly stressful, and the exams themselves were incredibly fair, which was nice after taking some past exams with fairly memorization-heavy questions (like coding an OCaml parser from memory). Finally, Cliff and the TA's seem to know when things were screwed up, such as with quiz 1 and project 2, which is reassuring. Overall, you will likely do well with Cliff. Exam averages were around 85 across the board, and nothing seemed too unreasonable at the end of the day (well, almost). I think he's middle of the road right now, but chances are with a bit of fine tuning, he'll turn out to be a great professor. Hopefully things get sorted out, as I understand the course is going through some growing pains right now. At the end of the day, I would still recommend Cliff. That is, if you had the choice, as CS class registration is in a terrible place right now. One more thing, I didn't really like Rust as the final language of 330. It kind of just boiled down into a mess of language rules, and the rust projects were not as effective as the OCaml projects in getting us acquainted to the language imo. The original plan was to tack on Racket, and honestly, I would have much rather had that instead of Rust, as I feel it ties into the themes of the course much better. It also has the side effect (get it) of preparing us better for 430.
Cliff Bakalian CMSC330 ☆☆☆☆☆ Expecting an A Anonymous 12/19/2023	Overall, I thought Cliff was decent. 40% of your grade comes from projects. The only projects that were annoying were project 2 and project 6. Project 2 in my opinion was too much. Period. Project 6 was okay, but the evaluator part was somewhat annoying. You have 2 mid terms both 12% and one final worth 22%. All exams are very fair, except the year I took it Kauffman and Cliff were coteaching. I think some exams were written by Kauffman. Then you have quizzes and lecture quizzes. Lecture quizzes are fine and the quizzes are okay. When I took it, people performed poorly on quiz 1. Cliff as a lecturer is okay. He definitely can get boring at times, but goes over all the content you need to know. He is also extremely helpful in OH. The class also has a large amount of TA's. That's a plus as well.

Information	Review
Cliff Bakalian CMSC330 ★☆☆☆☆ Expecting a B- Anonymous 12/17/2023	As a student, it feels to me that he designs the projects simply to trick students and not help them learn anything- showcases how smart he is! Looking back, I don't really understand why he taught the way he did as I don't know what I learned. On the other hand, watching the other instructor's (Kauffman) lectures really helped me learn and also appreciate the course a lot more. Avoid Cliff as much as possible if you want to maximize a stress free schedule while also getting value out of the class instead.
Cliff Bakalian CMSC330 ★★★★★ Expecting a B+ Anonymous 12/16/2023	Very good choice for 330. Pros: - Has notes for each topic that gives more information than the lectures - Office hours are very helpful (both Cliff's and the TA's) - Lecture Quizzes that are easy and give a small grade boost - Content on exam is spread out so there aren't too many points on one topic - Also exams aren't hard - Listens to feedback about class assignments Cons: - Projects can be hard at times - A few of the projects were also confusing but TA's were responsive on piazza - Quizzes were hard (There are 4 in total each weighed 2.5%) Overall: If you start projects early (Basically the day they come out) and you use office hours, they're doable. Study for quizzes and exams. If you study throughout the semester, studying for exams won't be as bad. Also make sure you understand the topics well since you will (most likely) have a project on it.
Cliff Bakalian CMSC330 ★★★★☆ Expecting an A Anonymous 12/16/2023	Chill and class covers some interesting content. Some projects (especially project 2) were hard because of a lack of organization and foresight in project descriptions; if you had Larry and complained about his long project descriptions, these projects will make you appreciate them. Overall I think he was alright, I think a lot of salty people leave bad reviews because they are being confronted with the fact that a CS degree requires learning about how computers and programming actually works and not just making JS web-apps or something. So many people don't go to lecture but I highly recommend it, if you don't he has very good notes as supplement though.
Anders Spear CMSC330 ★★★★★ Expecting an A Anonymous 12/16/2023	Super funny and super helpful. Take class with Anders if you can.
Christopher Kauffman CMSC330 ★★★★★ Expecting an A Anonymous 12/16/2023	Great lecturer. I had him when he was coteaching with Bakalian, but the content was well-taught, and the online notes were good. Has extra credit for participation in lectures and discussions, which can be a huge advantage, and course is project weighted.
Cliff Bakalian CMSC330 ★★★☆☆ Expecting an A Anonymous 12/16/2023	Cliff is really smart but his teaching style really did not work for me. He did a decent job of giving us the content, but does a bad job of explaining how the topics that we learn intertwine together, so it feels like we are learning random arbitrary topics for a while until the pieces finally go together in your own head. The projects in this class were a mess. I believe a TA wrote project 2, and the description was really vague and no one really had any clue how to do it. Project 6 was also a really poorly written project – both needed added resources halfway through the project to help students understand what they had to do.

Information	Review
Cliff Bakalian CMSC330 ☆☆☆☆☆ Expecting an A Anonymous 12/15/2023	Cliff is a good lecturer, I think most of these reviews are overly harsh. Cliff's lectures are boring, but he makes great lecture notes so going to class is practically optional. Exams are incredibly fair. My only complaint with Cliff is that some of the projects were too difficult and took too much time, and I wasn't a fan of having quizzes (only four though), but other than that he is a great lecturer.
Cliff Bakalian CMSC330 ☆☆☆☆☆ Expecting an A Anonymous 12/15/2023	Cliff is the definition of mid, the definition of a 3 star professor. Basically every aspect about his class structure and personality is mid. Not bad, not good. - Lectures: Sometimes very informative, sometimes big wastes of time. Sometimes I'm engaged; most of the time I am not. The semester started with him using slides (which were really just visual aids for him and didn't serve as useful notes), but devolved into him just typing notes into Vim later into the semester as he talked. Lots of time wasted trying to spell correctly. Publishes decently useful notes. - Exams: Two midterms. Usually pretty fair if not easy. Usually hits you with a couple really ambiguous multiple choice or true/false but he double majored in philosophy so he likes things abstract and theoretical. Cumulative final. - Projects: Some were really, really hard. Others were fine. Lets you submit as many times as possible. No grading on style-- just tests, and usually these are all public or a mix of public and semipublic. Secret tests were on a couple projects but not most. As a result, they took a long time, but as long as you were able to get through it, they were easy guaranteed As. Project descriptions were kind of terse and didn't really describe what to do in edge cases, and I often had to rely on Piazza posts to get a full understanding of the project. But to be fair, going from Larry to Cliff was a big jump and usually he just doesn't test weird edge cases like Larry would. - Discussions: Completely optional unless there is a quiz. Dates for discussion quizzes given at the start of the semester. Quizzes are sometimes a time crunch. 4 quizzes throughout the semester. - Reachability: I went to Cliff's office hours once and he was kind of standoffish. I've heard TAs are helpful and they are very responsive and helpful on Piazza. - Personality: I think Cliff is a chill guy but often times he just kind of came off as boring. He's weirdly interested in unconventional programming languages like Shakespeare and INTERCAL, but luckily this class's content allows him to talk about that a little and relate it to the lecture content and it was decently interesting. I'm basically entirely indifferent to Cliff. The class was fine. The semester was fine. I performed fine and am expecting an A. Wouldn't mind taking him again.
Ceren Mert CMSC330 ☆☆☆☆☆ Expecting a B- jaccboe 12/11/2023	Ceren is a very friendly and intelligent TA. She is very kind and easy to talk with, and is excellent at teaching. Although Ceren does not have a discussion section, she does have office hours, and she is incredibly helpful there. She is very good at explaining project descriptions and class concepts, and has helped me many times. She has hosted review sessions in lieu of exams and even posted some of her own personal notes on our Piazza to study from. She clearly cares about the students and their success. I highly recommend this TA.
Jared Fleming CMSC330 ☆☆☆☆☆ Expecting a B- Anonymous 12/11/2023	Jared is a kind and welcoming TA. He does not have a discussion section, but he does have office hours. At office hours, he is extremely helpful and a great teacher. With only a glance, he can read through code or directions for a project, understand what is being asked, and figure out what your issue is. He is excellent at explaining concepts and helping you identifying issues. I've almost always been able to figure out my issues after he explains, and it always feels rewarding learning from him. Highly recommend this TA as he is very knowledgeable.
Anthony Gomes CMSC330 ☆☆☆☆☆ Expecting an A+ Anonymous 12/11/2023	Best TA ever

Information	Review
Christopher Kauffman CMSC330 ★★★★★ Expecting a B+ Purplefox 12/10/2023	Professor Kauffman nailed everything you could want and expect of a professor. Despite being new to the department and the class, he quickly took charge of the material. His slides were excellent, covering history, documentation, example code, and exercises with answers. He gave us time to work on exercises, discuss with classmates, and always answered questions. He genuinely cared about making sure we understood the material. He had amazing integrity, owning up to his own mistakes. He even provided recordings of the sessions. Professor Kauffman went above and beyond by sharing his opinions on the topics and discussing their practicality. He questioned why we covered certain topics and where the information came from. Overall, Professor Kauffman is a great addition to the CS Department, and I would recommend taking a class with him if you get the chance.
Vasu Mittal CMSC330 ★★★★★ Expecting a B+ Purplefox 12/10/2023	This TA is one of the best I've had in the CMSC department. I was lucky to have him for my discussion. He outperformed most other TAs by answering questions, sharing his notes and insights, and keeping the class engaged. His discussions often included a comprehensive review of the material that helped me understand topics even when I had no clue before, making it easier to handle projects and discussion tasks. Interestingly, another student even switched to attending his discussion instead of their assigned session. When he couldn't make it to discussion, he found a substitute TA instead of just canceling. Vasu was very kind and genuinely cared for his fellow classmates. I couldn't have asked for a better TA.
Anthony Gomes CMSC330 ★★★★★ Anonymous 12/09/2023	Best TA ever he explained everything well and ensured I learned the material before heading to another person
Zoya Tasneem CMSC330 ★★★★★ Expecting a B Anonymous 12/08/2023	Zoya is a very knowledgeable and well spoken TA. She shows mastery over course material, and is excellent at teaching it to us. If you are struggling in lecture, going to her discussion filled those gaps. I sometimes find that her discussions are actually more helpful than going to the lecture. I cannot tell you how many people I have seen go out of their way to attend her discussion and skip theirs. She is very kind and is easily approachable. Highly recommend this TA and going to her discussion section and office hours.
Christopher Kauffman CMSC330 ★★★★★ Expecting an A Anonymous 12/07/2023	Professor Kauffman is easily one of the best professors I've had at UMD so far, up there in Justin levels of greatness. Right here is a teacher who really seems like they care about the subject can teach it in a way thats easy to understand and seems to care for the students as well. He's personable, funny, and I am probably more engaged in his lectures than I am in any other CS lecture I've had before. One thing I love is that he'll always answer questions and is happy to do so. He's got funny little nerdy references in his slides as well which is nice coming from Larry. Overall, his command of the subject is impressive but not surprising given his experience. Everything he teaches in based off of textbooks or some source so you know what you're learning is legit and is following some level of a standard (and not just the arbitrary musings of some researcher). He comes off as a little passive aggressive sometimes, but in a funny way and only when its warranted (a kid won't stop asking questions that are pointless and interrupt class, someone asks a question that was just answered, etc.). His slides were also pretty good, sort of dense but filled with useful motivating examples. The worst part of this experience with him was that it felt like he was always being hampered down by coteaching with Cliff, which makes sense. This is a man with 20+ years of educational experience, coming from the University of Minnesota and GWU (with raving reviews at both) and he shouldn't really have to coteach so I hope he isn't in the future. The projects that he himself wrote (project 7 and 8) were easier to understand and do compared to the collaborative ones which is good and I felt like I put in my time, learned something, and could walk away happy. If there are seats open for this man, take him. I just hope he stays at UMD because I think his ways of teaching should be an example for the whole department.

Information	Review
Cliff Bakalian CMSC330 ★ ★ ★ ☆ ☆ Expecting an A- Anonymous 11/28/2023	very mid ngl -good notes -horribly boring lectures -some well-written projects -some very disorganized projects -exams are like practices -quizzes are pretty chill other than the first one -not insanely challenging exam wise -projects are more tedious and leave more to interpretation -tas are good, but they are always in the room and like never helping -quick piazza posts long story short, idt i learned shit, but this class isn't the worst
Cliff Bakalian CMSC330 ★ ★ ★ ★ ☆ Expecting an A- Anonymous 11/26/2023	very chill and fun guy (nice hair), nice tas too extremely helpful detailed note pages and fairly decent, understandable lectures quiz 1 and project 2 were absurdly difficult but he seems receptive to feedback - gave extra late tokens after the horrors of project 2 and pretty much every project and quiz after has been easier and more reasonable not a perfect class but it feels like he's down to earth and working to improve which is always good
Christopher Kauffman CMSC330 ★ ★ ★ ★ ★ Expecting an A andru epabloske 11/17/2023	Very funny and helpful guy who cares a lot about your learning. Take him!
Cliff Bakalian CMSC330 ★ ☆ ☆ ☆ ☆ Anonymous 11/16/2023	Nothing against Cliff but I am at a loss for words regarding the new projects introduced this semester (Project 2 and Project 6). If you can't provide a solid description for each project, how do you expect students to understand what they are being tested on for secret tests? it is a guessing game at this point and a good chunk of your grade is at stake.
Zoya Tasneem CMSC330 ★ ☆ ☆ ☆ ☆ Expecting an A Anonymous 11/14/2023	Asked for help during office hours. Provided no information, then left prematurely as she had a meeting. Did not transfer me to another TA to continue our discussion, and forced me to wait 21 more spots in the line to speak with another TA. Her proposed changes did not make sense and she did not explain them when asked.
Cliff Bakalian CMSC330 ★ ★ ★ ★ ☆ Anonymous 11/12/2023	organized class and some extra credit(<2%). but the lectures arent the best. OH should help though
Jugraj Singh CMSC330 ★ ★ ★ ★ ★ Anonymous 11/12/2023	One of the best TAs! Gives examples to help you understand concept. Additionally, he will guide you to an answer rather than giving you the answer!

Information	Review
Cliff Bakalian CMSC330 ☆☆☆☆☆ Expecting a B Anonymous 11/12/2023	Don't take this class lightly. I got an A+ in CMSC216, but it seems like every project in this class is worse than the next. Despite never procrastinating on them and starting the day they're assigned, sometimes it's just not feasible to finish the projects without spending over 20 hours on them. The project descriptions are vague, and whenever I went to office hours, the TA's agreed that compared to the semesters they took this course, the projects seemed more harsh and convoluted. I will say, Cliff is good at explaining the topics, the TA's are wonderful at explaining things and even if you're stuck with a crappy one for your discussion section, there's enough that if you go to office hours you WILL get any question you have about material answered. The material itself isn't overly challenging, and the tests are fair with a lot of practice material provided. But for a class so heavily dependent on the projects, I wish they'd put more thought into the workload they're assigning.
Cliff Bakalian CMSC330 ☆☆☆☆☆ Expecting an A Anonymous 11/10/2023	Cliff is an incredibly boring lecturer but he provides you with every resource you need to succeed. Practice quizzes and exams are super helpful. This semester, one quiz and one project were extremely difficult but the difficulty has since gone down.
Cliff Bakalian CMSC330 ☆☆☆☆☆ Expecting an A Anonymous 11/09/2023	I think these reviews are generally too tough. The only thing holding my review back from 5 stars is the quizzes, which feel unnecessarily stressful, despite only being 2.5% of your grade each. Other than that, I think the class is taught well, and I really like Cliff's lecture notes, which cover basically everything that happens in lecture, and are very well-written. He also gives you access to previous exams and quizzes to study. The projects are probably more difficult then they should be, but if you start early you will be fine.
Christopher Kauffman CMSC330 ☆☆☆☆☆ Anonymous 11/08/2023	I'm not actually his student for this course, but I've relied entirely on his posted lectures and supplemental code to get me through this course, so I felt I should leave a review since I chose another professor over him due to the lack of reviews. He's very knowledgeable, charismatic, and sometimes humorous. I've heard great things from his students. The way he explains things just sit super neatly in my head which I am not used to in CS. Take Kauffman!!
Cliff Bakalian CMSC330 ☆☆☆☆☆ Anonymous 11/05/2023	Absolutely horrendous projects, they basically boil down to whether you can guess what he wants you to do.
Christopher Kauffman CMSC330 ☆☆☆☆☆ Anonymous 11/03/2023	he can quickly adapt to teaching any course even if he's initially unfamiliar with them. very understanding when a huge curveball exists and is unafraid to admit mistakes. if you are ever curious and want to go more in-depth in the content, he links resources to do so.
Christopher Kauffman CMSC330 ☆☆☆☆☆ Anonymous 10/19/2023	first review!! prof k is awesome, he explains concepts super well, has awesome content (slides, code), and is truly passionate about what he teaches. i never thought i'd be so interested in programming languages, but here we are.
Cliff Bakalian CMSC330 ☆☆☆☆☆ Anonymous 09/30/2023	Cliff needs to chill with these quizzes

Information	Review
Jugraj Singh CMSC330 ★ ★ ★ ★ ★ Anonymous 09/25/2023	bro is lit. explains concepts really nicely and helps patiently.
Cliff Bakalian CMSC330 ★ ★ ★ ☆ ☆ Anonymous 09/22/2023	The two reviews below were unnecessarily mean and did not explain in enough detail. Look, Cliff's a good guy. And he's smart. But there have already been so many unclear things this semester, leaving a lot of the class frustrated. The first quiz was rough. The median score was 11.5/20. The reason for this is largely the fact that we had only 20 minutes for two write-in coding portions, plus other fill-in-the-bubble questions, a few of which were annoying trick questions. Project 2 was worse. The description was imprecise, and I had to turn to Piazza to understand what exactly he wanted, which nobody should have to do. Not to mention the fact that it was far too difficult for a project that was primarily intended to test your knowledge of regular expressions. I had to give up after spending my entire Friday night & whole day Saturday on it, while still failing two semi-publics. I've never had to do that in the past (granted, I had Larry Herman for my past two project based classes, who is probably way TOO descriptive). The most difficult part of the project also had nothing to do with any new content, and everything to do with (a) understanding what the heck we're even supposed to be writing, and (b) basically recursion stuff, which we all know how to do, but which was further complicated by various things Cliff had done to intentionally make the project more difficult. There have been several other things. One is that, up until maybe the day before the first quiz, the syllabus had said that quizzes were open-note. And they weren't. Next, navigating his slides are like navigating fields of landmines. The slides have like three layers to them, and you can go up, down, left, or right. Which is further complicated by the fact that the slides appear to have a mind of their own, and they'll shift to random places when hitting the left or right arrows, when all you want to do is go back or forward one slide. Perhaps Cliff's saving grace is the fact that he, and his large army of TAs, respond fairly quickly to Piazza posts. And he has notes online that have basically all the content, which is a plus. He is not a terrible lecturer at all, and he knows his stuff, which can't be said of everyone. And I genuinely feel bad that he's getting so much heat right now. But he does have some things to work on. I hope he realizes that, and the rest of the semester can be smoother.
Cliff Bakalian CMSC330 ★ ★ ★ ★ ★ Anonymous 09/21/2023	Just countering the most recent 2 ratings after this (as a different/current) student There was a recent project that was convoluted and made by some TA(s). There were a lot of typos and it was confusing and vague. Cliff tried his best being super responsive on Piazza and clearing up any questions so I really wouldn't blame him. It was just not a good time overall for students and I understand ppl are stressed hence the bad reviews below. But overall Cliff so far has been really great
Cliff Bakalian CMSC330 ★ ☆ ☆ ☆ ☆ Anonymous 09/20/2023	Horrible project descriptions making your life hell
Cliff Bakalian CMSC330 ★ ☆ ☆ ☆ ☆ Anonymous 09/20/2023	kid thinks hes philosophical with it but hes just booooooooooring and the projects are dog water

Information	Review
Cliff Bakalian CMSC330 ★☆☆☆☆ Anonymous 09/19/2023	Terrible assignment descriptions, unfair quizzes, unhelpful explanations.
Cliff Bakalian CMSC330 ★☆☆☆☆ Anonymous 09/19/2023	Boring lecturer but cannot write a coherent project description to save his life. Cliff needs to take ENGL393 or something before attempting to write a project.
Cliff Bakalian CMSC330 ★★★★★ Expecting an A Anonymous 09/12/2023	Nice guy. Had him for 330 after 250 in the fall of 2022 and he taught the class pretty well. Quizzes and exams were pretty fair game and you'll be fine if you practice his old papers and go to office hours for help. Cliff is approachable in his office hours and explains stuff pretty well. Will miss him. Cliff, if you see this, thanks for being a good prof for a year. Have a good rest of your life
Cliff Bakalian CMSC330 ★★★★☆ Expecting a C+ Anonymous 05/29/2023	Lectures are very dull and monotone. But as long as you start on the projects they seemed alright (this class is horrible for procrastinators). I would recommend using class slides from other classes as well because Cliff's slides are really hard to navigate. Overall, decent class and he is understanding but doesn't really check his emails.
Cliff Bakalian CMSC330 ★★★★★ Expecting an A- atp236 05/28/2023	330 with Cliff was a solid choice. 330 as a class: this class was run much better than 216, so that was a breath of fresh air. There were a lot of TAs to handle OH, and the TAs I got help from knew what they were doing. There was a lot of practice material online from previous semesters, but I feel like the style of questions changed this spring 2023 semester because assessments were all in-person instead of online. However, I will say the exams and quizzes were fair game (if you really understand the material, I think it's possible to do well, though I flopped them myself Projects were within reason if you vaguely understand the topics, start early, visit OH, and get the help that you need. Cliff as a lecturer: he got the job done (I mean he really is the only option so you can't escape unless you drop out...?). He covered everything that was tested on (whether it be verbally or through writing), though I will say there were a few times I probably fell asleep in that lecture hall. Going to discussion to learn how to do NFA to DFA and OpSem were helpful. Overall, I wouldn't be too worried about this class with Cliff. I felt much less stressed in 330 with Cliff compared to 216.
Cliff Bakalian CMSC330 ★★★★★ Expecting an A Anonymous 05/26/2023	- Good professor who is engaging and is very communicative with his students - Very easy to email or to reach out to - exam accurately reflects content in the course - Large amount of TA's in Office Hours (sometimes takes a while to get help if u go at a bad time, but overall good amount of TA's)

Information	Review
Cliff Bakalian CMSC330 ★★☆☆☆ Expecting a B- akI2025 05/26/2023	Amazing professor. Helpful TAs. Definitely recommend him. Pros: - Resources: you have all you need to review for quizzes and exams. Go to the class website and practice! - Office hours: a lot of smart TAs are there to help. Cons: - Quizzes/Exams: I don't think I'm great at functional programming because I usually struggle with the topics. Even when I understand the contents, I make lots of dumb mistakes and I lose a lot of points on exams. But if you thrive, then congrats! - Lectures: sometimes boring and dry, but you have the notes and TAs. A few words of advice: start the projects early! Don't procrastinate. Have a good time management because you definitely will need it while doing the project and reviewing for the quiz or exam. Have a study group, too!
Cliff Bakalian CMSC330 ★★☆☆☆ Expecting an A- Anonymous 05/21/2023	Cliff is nice and his exams are fair. He has a lot of great TA's and the projects are also not bad at all. The only con I'd say is that Cliff's lecture style is a bit dull and boring to endure for 75 minutes, which I think could be fixed by recording his lectures, but Cliff does not seem to be interested in recording his lectures. But other than that, he's great!
Cliff Bakalian CMSC330 ★★☆☆☆ Expecting an A Anonymous 05/20/2023	Probably my favorite CS class I've taken. Cliff's lectures are good if you can stay awake (I usually did not). Exams are straightforward and fair. Project were reasonable difficulty and really helped reinforce concepts learned in class. He does not record his lectures, but do have pretty good lecture notes, some topics do not have notes but I had no problem using online resources to get through. There was a slight curve at the end for my semester. Overall, a solid professor.
Cliff Bakalian CMSC330 ★★☆☆☆ Expecting an A- Anonymous 05/19/2023	Pretty good teacher. Actually cares about how the students are doing and has extended deadlines for projects when everyone was struggling. Only things that were annoying were there always being several errors on the exams that are found while we are taking the exam. Also he didn't lectures for some reason. In substitute for not recording the lectures, he would put out his own notes that he produced. These notes were usually pretty good imo but he just stopped making them towards the last month. For the Rust and garbage collection, he just linked us to previous year's slides which annoyed me.
Cliff Bakalian CMSC330 ★★☆☆☆ Anonymous 05/18/2023	He has good notes on the topics and gives a lot of practice exams to use for studying
Cliff Bakalian CMSC330 ★★☆☆☆ Expecting an A- Anonymous 05/17/2023	Cliff for 330 is by far the best choice. Some words of advice would be to start the projects early as the majority of them will be difficult and time consuming, but they are all doable. He give a lot of great resources and his TAs are all really good and knowledgeable, plus he has a lot of them, more than I've seen in any other class I've taken.
Cliff Bakalian CMSC330 ★★☆☆☆ Anonymous 05/15/2023	You're in good hands. Good lecturer, very helpful on piazza. Absolute memelord as well and has lego kits on display in his office. About the review that complained about Exam 1, all you had to do was explain what you roughly did. You could even bullshit and come up with a solution on the spot as long as you knew what the project was (you should). The other part of that question was literally just a critical thinking exercise (as long as you did the project). Also, if a project is due before the exam, it's fair game and you know that.

Information	Review
Cliff Bakalian CMSC330 ★★☆☆☆ Expecting an A- Anonymous 05/15/2023	Kind of nerdy, cool guy. Decent lecturer, but he doesn't record. Just show up and that doesn't matter. Rough but doable projects, one in particular was extremely difficult but as usual, start early and you'll be fine. Pretty reasonable exams and quizzes. Just show up to class, pay attention and take good notes, and you'll do well.
Cliff Bakalian CMSC330 ★★☆☆☆ Expecting a C- Anonymous 05/14/2023	Cliff's overall a great professor and class is not too hard. My grade likely doesn't reflect that statement, but that's entirely my fault.
Cliff Bakalian CMSC330 ★★☆☆☆ Expecting a B Anonymous 05/08/2023	Cliff is a good professor. His lectures may seem monotonous but if you listen and take notes you will understand the topic. Projects are perfect, not too easy neither too hard. The Worst part is Slides. OMG Cliff has a map like slides which are so vague and annoying. This was so difficult cuz even if you listen in lecture towards the end of the semester you might need review concepts and his slides are just a big disappointment.
Cliff Bakalian CMSC330 ★★☆☆☆ Expecting an A- Anonymous 05/08/2023	Cliff is a great professor for this class. He is always well prepared for lectures, he has a dry humor that is engaging and he explains concepts clearly with good examples. The projects are challenging but we are given plenty of time and they are really interesting. He is understanding and gives discussion notes on the class github that are great for helping us with where to start on projects. I had a lot of fun in this class. He slays.
Cliff Bakalian CMSC330 ★★☆☆☆ Expecting an A Anonymous 05/06/2023	Cliff managed to take an incredibly well-designed course put together by professors like Jose and David Van Horn and turn it into a disorganized mess. It seemed like he almost never actually prepared for lecture or planned content out ahead of time. Rather than providing slides, Cliff would often just whip out a sheet of paper and decide what we would cover that day on a whim. I felt like he did a disservice to the content of this course and am disappointed that he will be the only instructor for it again next semester. The only reason I am not giving him one star is that he is very understanding of students' concerns. However, it seemed to me throughout the semester that Cliff was more interested in playing the part of a "cool professor" than competently doing his job as a lecturer. He has a lot of room to improve.
Cliff Bakalian CMSC330 ★★☆☆☆ Expecting an A- Anonymous 05/06/2023	I like Cliff. He's a pretty chill dude and has blimps of humor here and there. I would heavily recommend going to lecture even if he has online slides because he covers material that may be difficult to understand strictly from reading. The projects are hard but reasonable if you stay on track and don't procrastinate. Expect to spend a decent amount of time on them, but once you complete them, you'll feel like a god.
Cliff Bakalian CMSC330 ★★☆☆☆ Anonymous 05/01/2023	Taking 330 with Cliff is the right choice. Projects are challenging but not overly so, and his lectures are good, albeit a bit boring. But, he is funny and accessible and gets a lot of points for that.
Cliff Bakalian CMSC330 ★★☆☆☆ Expecting an A Anonymous 04/30/2023	Cliff is a really cool guy; I found his lecture's interesting and he explains the concepts really well. The projects are fun and he always went over helpful examples in class to help us get started. He is very detail oriented and explains thoroughly which I appreciated. I think he made this class very enjoyable!

Information	Review
Cliff Bakalian CMSC330 ☆☆☆☆ Expecting an A mbatukam 04/29/2023	His lectures are boring and he puts a lot of time into explaining irrelevant things rather than the main points. The projects are pretty well written though, they have steps/helper functions that you put together to make the final thing
Anders Spear CMSC330 ☆☆☆☆ Expecting a B+ Anonymous 04/27/2023	pretty good discussion TA, makes mistakes sometimes but corrects them the following week
Cliff Bakalian CMSC330 ☆☆☆☆ Expecting a B+ Anonymous 04/05/2023	Overcomplicates lectures. Easy topics are discussed in such convoluted ways. Throws out terms and uses them without properly defining them. Dry lectures, doesn't record. lecture slides are subpar, however he does give decent notes that accompany the slides. Some trivial exam questions. However Exam 1 for this year was terrible, he expected us to remember how we implemented projects from a month or two ago. The data structure was super complex and he just expected us to remember how we did it.
Cliff Bakalian CMSC330 ☆☆☆☆ Expecting a C+ Anonymous 04/01/2023	CMSC330 is a tough class. Go to office hours and start the projects early. Set aside a lot of time to prepare for the exams/quizzes/bi-weekly lecture quizzes.
Jose Calderon CMSC330 ☆☆☆☆ Expecting an A- Anonymous 03/27/2023	I have the same opinions as most of the reviews here. His lectures align well with projects, quizzes and tests. His office hours are amazing because of his diverse knowledge and he is extremely responsive to emails and piazza. I struggled with his lecture style at first. The way he communicated information during lecture was not organized in a way where he states some topic, underlines it, then gives you the information about it. It's more of a stream of information with no structure and he writes things down that are really important or helpful for visualizing where he's going with a point. You will need to determine the structure of your notes yourself and pay attention to everything he says, not just what he writes down. If you come awake and willing to learn his lectures are full valuable and relevant material.
Jose Calderon CMSC330 ☆☆☆☆ Expecting a B+ theGreat 01/20/2023	Definition of a 5 start professor - great lecturer - genuinely cares about his students - very knowledgable - well structured course - answers emails
Cliff Bakalian CMSC330 ☆☆☆☆ Expecting a B+ theGreat 01/20/2023	Pros: - lots of good TAs - nice guy that will try to answer your questions Cons: - difficult to contact - provided lecture notes are horrible - often in lecture he gets lost and doesn't know what hes talking about which is kinda annoying - overall just felt like he didn't know the content very well and wasn't great at teaching it either. It was his first time teaching the course though so ill give him the benefit of the doubt.

Information	Review
Jose Calderon CMSC330 ☆☆☆☆☆ Expecting a B+ Anonymous 12/24/2022	Jose is extremely fair, as is seen in his class and exams. He's also very nice, and his class is highly interactive, and OH open for students. I would note that his teaching style did not jive with me at all, and left me very confused, so I used slides from last year to succeed in the class. Jose may be very popular, but like others have said, I definitely didn't feel the hype.
Jose Calderon CMSC330 ☆☆☆☆☆ Expecting an A Charl1e1029 12/23/2022	So... I will admit that this class was pretty unorganized and left a lot of responsibility to the student. Although they provided us with past exams/quizzes to use as reference, a lot of course material covered in the past was no longer covered this semester, and some new concepts were introduced that weren't covered in the past so there were no study materials regarding those topics. Other than exams, I though Jose's lectures were informative and invigorating, and the projects were straightforward and quite do-able. Tokens were provided to give some leeway into submitting projects a bit later with no penalty, but personally I didn't need to use even a single one.
Jose Calderon CMSC330 ☆☆☆☆☆ Expecting an A+ Anonymous 12/20/2022	To say I was disappointed by the hype surrounding Jose would be an understatement. He is a very down to Earth guy, very caring, and is overall one of the most kind and easy to talk to people in the entire department. Office hours with him were great, he was very approachable and I couldn't have asked for a better professor in that regard. Lecture wise, wow did I really not enjoy them. The biggest flaw to me was Jose's obsession with doing all his teaching on pen and paper rather than utilizing the very very thorough pre-made slides from previous lectures or using a code editor. This made some things such as NFA/DFA a nightmare and anything regarding syntax and coding. Despite Jose's best attempts, I just didn't resonate with how he taught in lectures and often had to go back to previous semesters and look at the slides. I understand he co-taught with Cliff and Cliff is the top dog for this class but even he used slides and others supplementary material to help us understand things outside of lecture, while Jose did not. I'm sure he was busy with his own personal things but I don't see why people think he's one of the best lecturers in the department.
Cliff Bakalian CMSC330 ☆☆☆☆☆ Expecting an A Anonymous 12/20/2022	I reviewed Cliff for 250 during Fall 2021 but I feel compelled to submit another review as I strongly disagree with his current rating and my opinion only strengthened when I took him for 330 during Spring 2022. He was an effective professor - sure he sometimes speaks monotonically, but he teaches the concepts very well. The pacing of his classes were perfect, and the projects and exams were extremely fair. He's also just a straight up nice guy; he's been through the UMD CS program himself and he knows how it is to be a student going through the very classes he's teaching. I strongly recommend Cliff, really can't go wrong by picking him.
Jose Calderon CMSC330 ☆☆☆☆☆ Expecting an A ceremonialgradematcha 12/18/2022	jose's office hours were very helpful, although the course was not very well-organized. i actually started going to his office hours because the tas couldn't explain project 4 or grammars well, and i think the instructor should be at least partially responsible for making sure the tas know the basic concepts of the course. this course was cotaught with cliff, but the lecture quizzes rarely covered material we in jose's section learned in class, and i think jose should've been more involved with the course organization as well as teaching. he records his lectures, which is great, and his online notes are really helpful, although they're posted about a week after the class instead of right after for some reason. i also think his expectations for us as a class are slightly high. i remember him saying "don't rely on past exams for practice, instead write your own problems" which imo is above and beyond what should be expected of us; the class is challenging enough as is. tl;dr course slightly disorganized but very helpful individually.
Jose Calderon CMSC330 ☆☆☆☆☆ Expecting an A Anonymous 12/17/2022	Just gotta go to lecture and take some notes. Fun class, learned a bunch. Wish we spent more time on Rust though...

Information	Review
Cliff Bakalian CMSC330 ☆☆☆☆ Expecting an A ceremonialgradematcha 12/17/2022	jose and cliff cotaught this semester and i had jose, but this class was run more like a cliff class (everything on gradescope, quizzes, an online exam1, etc.) so it seemed like cliff was in charge of (and i'll blame him more for) course administration. in other words, this review is solely for course organization and not for his actual teaching. - lecture quizzes did not match what i learned in lecture. just cause i don't have cliff doesn't mean my section matters any less, and it's up to the instructors to make sure they material and the quizzes sync up between them. - the 5 large quizzes were all 20 minutes each, when they needed more time. i don't know why 250 got 2-hour quizzes but 330 20-minute ones. - office hours were a crapshoot; half the tas couldn't do project 4. obviously this isn't directly reflective of the instructor but he should at least put some effort into making sure all his tas are at least capable of the basic things students are expected to do. - exam 1 was poorly organized. the exam was way too long, and it seemed like although the tas each submitted a question they thought was ok, the fact that almost no one managed to finish that exam in time showed that no one testsolved it and that the tas' questions weren't organized and selected well. again, my review is only relevant to courses he administrates, not his lecturing style or competency. so, if you actually have him for a class, ymmv.
Roger Eastman CMSC330 ☆☆☆☆ Expecting a W nightingale 12/17/2022	Terrible, terrible professor for this course! Came to class every lecture unprepared (as if computer science at UMD isn't hard enough without an awful teacher). He acted lost in front of the class. Also very unaccommodating and elitist.
Jose Calderon CMSC330 ☆☆☆☆ Expecting a B+ Anonymous 12/16/2022	this class genuinely traumatized me
Cliff Bakalian CMSC330 ☆☆☆☆ Anonymous 12/15/2022	Cliff is better professor for 330 than 250 IMO. He was definitely more interested in the material. Can be monotone at times, but covers the material well and gives a ton of practice resources for quizzes and exams.

Information	Review
Jose Calderon CMSC330 ☆☆☆☆☆ Expecting an A Anonymous 12/12/2022	Personally I really enjoy Jose's lecturing style. It is very active, he asks a lot of questions of the class. We go through a lot of examples, and most of the lecture is Jose writing or typing out examples. If it's an interactive or syntax-heavy topic he will usually have an interpreter or compiler on his laptop on the projector. If it's more of a conceptual topic he's writing examples out on paper. Humor is subjective so some people may be annoyed by his humor, as well as his pet peeves. If you say "method" when you mean "function/procedure/...", he will say "what do you mean 'method'?" or similar. Same thing with statements vs expressions. I agree with him on the importance of being precise in wording and preserving the actual meaning of words (as long as that is their meaning, though meaning can change through change in use, but functions are NOT methods). Some people may be annoyed by this. Do note that it is not a big thing, and from what I remember it's basically just "method" and "statement" that comes up in 330, and they're pretty important distinctions. To me it feels more like he focuses on things that are dangers to your mental model understanding of the concept. Not understanding the difference between statements and expressions would be bad for your understanding of languages that focus on expressions and mutability. For some other topics loosey-goosey mental models seem to be fine by Jose, where the loose model doesn't harm your understanding. He's not a nitpicker. He rolls with answers to questions even if they're not his preferred way of phrasing or thinking about something. I feel he really tries to connect with the students and which part of a concept they're struggling with, then put more focus on that as needed. The discrepancy between content covered in Jose's lecture and what ends up on the lecture quiz, due to the course being co-taught by Jose and Cliff, is sometimes annoying. However I don't consider it that big a deal since you can use basically any resource for the lecture quizzes; you can consult others, run code samples, etc.
Jose Calderon CMSC330 ☆☆☆☆☆ Expecting a B Anonymous 12/02/2022	His written material could be better, but overall I'm a fan.
Jose Calderon CMSC330 ☆☆☆☆☆ Anonymous 11/18/2022	yeah he doesnt cover exactly whats on the lecture quizzes but he teaches so well that you can learn the underlying concepts and apply them more generally. ive probably learned more from this class than any other cs class i've taken. if you want a curriculum thats a bit closer to what's actually tested, though, cliff would be a better choice
Jose Calderon CMSC330 ☆☆☆☆☆ Expecting an A Anonymous 11/13/2022	I think his teaching style for this class is an acquired taste. He doesn't use slides, but instead handwrites on a piece of paper as he explains a concept. Before last week, he had a problem of not saying the name of a concept he taught so when we got the lecture quiz we were all confused. However, he is very receptive to changing his teaching to fit our needs and it's clear that he is very passionate about CS. He also answers a lot of questions during lecture.
Jose Calderon CMSC330 ☆☆☆☆☆ Expecting a B- Anonymous 11/11/2022	I mustve gotten unlucky or something this semester but Jose has generally been pretty bad. The first average on the exam was a 64% and 70% of the class got caught cheating on it (it was take-home). He focuses too much on the abstractness of a concept and doesn't teach us what we actually need to know. It kinda makes him seem like a smartass. The class is cotaught with Cliff and a lot of the stuff on the lecture quizzes are from Cliff's lectures and are never talked about in Jose's lecture. I was excited to take Jose but I will never register for him again. He is a nice guy but he just seems burnt out from lecturing or something.

Information	Review
Jose Calderon CMSC330 ★★★★☆ Expecting a B- Anonymous 11/08/2022	I never feel prepared for the lecture quizzes despite paying close attention during lecture and reviewing after. His teaching style is confusing and he only shows examples but doesn't really introduce things. So when there is a question to do a certain operation on something, I don't know what to do because he never said the name of that operation in class. Also, the lecture quiz questions are harder than the examples we did in class. I heard a lot of good things about Jose so I was really looking forward to taking this class with him, but I am left feeling confused after every lecture quiz which is very frustrating. Projects are very fair especially with help from the more accountable TAs, and yes, Jose is engaging and passionate so I'll still give him 4 stars. But I wish there was more organization to his lectures, and I doubt I would be doing as well as I am now if I was also taking CMSC351 at the same time which most people do.
Cliff Bakalian CMSC330 ★★★★☆ Expecting an A- log_n 08/04/2022	Just took CMSC330 with Cliff over the summer. The main issue with Cliff has been with his structure and administration of the course. Unclear deadlines and typos in assignments, quizzes, and slides were extremely commonplace when taking this course. Even what material we were going to cover over the condensed course was questioned a lot by the instructors and TAs. At one point, they even outright lied (probably not intentionally) about what was going to be covered/not covered on the final exam. All of this had a direct impact on the class, and this run of CMSC330 had some of the lowest exam averages on record (the class was curved substantially to make up for this). Apparently, this was due to Cliff somehow not being told that the course was going to only be 6 weeks long instead of 12 weeks long, but I digress. As a lecturer, Cliff was not the worst. He typed things out in Vim to demonstrate concepts, but he went fast and it was largely hit or miss if this approach beat out just sticking to dense slides. For instance, typing out code in Vim made sense, but once we got to NFAs/DFAs and grammars... Why not use whiteboarding software instead? One plus is that he'd post "Lecture Recap" videos for each lecture for those who couldn't make it to class. Although, these videos would often be posted 3-5 days after the lecture they covered, so relying on them to keep up is ill advised. While I didn't personally go to in person office hours (both in person and online OH were offered), those who did described the TAs as "rude" and "bothered by questions." This doesn't affect my evaluation of Cliff himself, but I felt that it was worth mentioning and pointing out that this is unacceptable behavior for TAs. Overall, I would still recommend taking courses with Cliff over many alternatives simply due to his approachable nature as well as his modern online approach to teaching. He is still young and can only improve with experience and I believe Cliff has the potential to be a good professor. He cares and is accommodating to students, but as of now, he still has a way to go (and needs new TAs) before being truly exceptional. Oh, and his hair was stunning.

Information	Review
Cliff Bakalian CMSC330 ★☆☆☆☆ Expecting a C- Justacoder 07/08/2022	I understand this is an accelerated summer class, that said some of the expectations made in this course were simply unacceptable. I found it quite obnoxious when Cliff would say we have 10 days for a project then proceed to wait a week before teaching us all the content needed for said project. The projects were honestly a pain. Some of the requirements felt more like tick questions designed to frustrate us rather than to actually display what we learned. That said lectures don't get uploaded during the weekend; perhaps Cliff also needs a break over the weekend; however it would be nice to have something to reference when we have projects to work on over the weekends. In any case, Cliffs lecturer's examples were usually inadequate and not clear; they were not a good foundation for these projects. The difficulty between what we learn in class and the projects is too large of a jump, perhaps it's not that surprising considering they are just reused projects from other professors, who gave weeks to work on the same projects we are given 6 days for. The lecture quizzes were quite a headache. The slides don't get uploaded the same day and so we are basically expected to just retain everything we had learned that day. The exams weren't great and averages weren't very good. We were provided older exams to reference; however working on projects consumed way too much time away from studying. A Lot of us had to make a choice between getting the project done or studying. Even now at this moment we have a 4 part project due Friday the same day as our final worth 27% of our grade. I must seriously question if anyone would find this reasonable. The class honesty left me feeling helpless at times, there needs to be more reasonable standards for projects and adequate time allocated on par with what we learn. I believe Cliff does care about these students but he needs to sort of look at things on our level and set reasonable expectations.
Cliff Bakalian CMSC330 ★☆☆☆☆ Expecting an A Anonymous 06/02/2022	Chill guy, nothing wrong with his teaching per say. He mainly seemed uninterested in teaching, and had zero enthusiasm when lecturing. Didn't really go into a lot of detail when doing example problems in lecture, and I had a hard time not falling asleep. Exams and projects were manageable. For projects just start early and got to OH asap if you are stuck.
Cliff Bakalian CMSC330 ★★★★☆ Expecting a B Anonymous 05/25/2022	Class lectures were a bit dry, though I would also blame the extremely dense powerpoints given for 330. While Cliff did at times do a good job explaining concepts to students and making sure to answer any questions, I ended up learning more by going to outside sources, and by doing the lecture quizzes and projects required for the course. Cliff definitely does care about his students though, and I don't think you'd do poorly if you had him as a professor.
Cliff Bakalian CMSC330 ★★★★☆ Expecting a B+ Anonymous 05/25/2022	The class pacing was fast but at the same time, I didn't want to learn the content because it was so uninteresting. In class, I did barely anything and I just looked at the slides during the lecture quizzes to learn the material for the day. He just seemed so tired after teaching CMSC250 that he didn't feel like teaching 330 at all. Seems like people were not fans of cmssc250 either. My TA was great though.

Information	Review
Cliff Bakalian CMSC330 ☆☆☆☆☆ Expecting an A Anonymous 05/21/2022	Very nice guy, I think that's evident based on all the reviews, and if you take any course he teaches you will feel the same. I feel like the reviews given for him for CMSC250 don't represent him as well. I had him last semester and got an A-, but he was pretty amazing for me. He did speak in a monotone manner though, which can be easily to cause you to daze a bit. People were saying he only has good reviews because he was co-teaching with Justin, but Cliff made his own slides for CMSC250 last semester and taught his own way, so I do feel he's being slandered a bit. Maybe it was because he was the main one to manage CMSC250 and Justin was the main one to manage it last semester, and if that's what people meant, then I suppose so. I felt he did great overall, but maybe this semester is different. I can't speak on that because I didn't take CMSC250 with him this semester, so my opinion may not be as valid as the others, although I feel the other reviews may be a bit over-exaggerated. In terms of CMSC330 though, he was pretty solid too. Not as much as 250 for me last semester, but he was still pretty good. He's very understanding as well. He doesn't question anything, as once I showed him what a TA said on a regrade request on my exam and fixed it on the spot, and he has a lot of sympathy for students. Sometimes he does get thrown off on a slide and gets confused or something, and sometimes he does blatantly read off the slides so going to lecture may not be optimal (he had lecture quizzes online so some people didn't really go to lecture, including me to be honest). The slides posted online helped me navigate through CMSC330 and helped build an understanding for each unit/topic we covered, along with understanding the whole purpose of the course. Sure, it may not be hard to post slides or he might have recycled them, but at the end of the day all the professor has to do is deliver information and make sure you understand it, and I felt like he accomplished that. The exams, quizzes, lecture quizzes, and projects of course were all online and open-note/internet as well, making it less stressful for students too. Overall, it was hard for me to pay attention in lecture at times, but that's just me. I sometimes even daze off even in Justin's lecture. Sometimes Cliff's lectures felt like "I can just look at the slides when he posts them", but then that turns into "I have to look at 15 slides the day before an exam" which i found myself doing a decent bit lol. I didn't give him a 5 star because his lectures are somewhat dull because he's monotone, and that makes it harder to pay attention, especially when you're already lost on some topic. He's very sympathetic, and has great potential to be a great professor though. Currently, I'd give him 4 stars, and for the future when he adjusts to lecturing, managing and leading courses, and overall improve over time, I'd say he's easily at-least a 4.5 star.
Cliff Bakalian CMSC330 ☆☆☆☆ Expecting an A- Anonymous 05/18/2022	I stopped going to his lectures and went to DVH's instead. In hindsight it was the right move as I went from having a 100% success rate of falling asleep in class to actually paying attention. I will say Cliff seems like a really chill guy and is approachable, however, I felt like he wasn't that interested with the content of 330, hence really dry lectures. Most of the material can be found on the slides or recordings so there's no need to show up. Exams were very fair. Projects weren't terrible(don't go to office hours last second). Quizzes were tough in terms of limited time, but doable.
Cliff Bakalian CMSC330 ☆☆☆☆☆ Expecting an A fiftyseven 05/16/2022	Cliff is generally a great guy and a pretty solid professor. He's very approachable and definitely tries his best to make the class interactive though it can be difficult given the lack of participation sometimes. He showed examples in REPls like irb and utop and I came out of lecturers feeling like I knew the content well. His style of drawing things out when they're complicated and showing examples in that manner gave some depth to his teaching that I really appreciated, especially in the finite automata units. Though I sometimes felt like the content was a bit dry, I found him to be a more than good professor. The exams and quizzes being online were also very nice.
Cliff Bakalian CMSC330 ☆☆☆☆☆ Expecting a C+ Anonymous 05/15/2022	extremely cool and also based professor. do not listen to the other girls. he slays too hard.

Information	Review
Cliff Bakalian CMSC330 ☆☆☆☆ Anonymous 05/13/2022	Cliff skips over important material in lectures, paces poorly, and does not truly attempt to check for understanding among the class. When nobody raises their hand to answer his lecture quiz questions, it would suggest that few are following the material. The class was still not particularly difficult, considering that exams were online and very fair. Watching David Van Horn's lecture videos were also great for getting up to speed. Cliff's lectures, however, are inadequate for engaging with the important material in this class. TLDR; the TAs and Van Horn's videos carried me through this class; would not currently recommend Cliff
Cliff Bakalian CMSC330 ☆☆☆☆ Expecting an A- Anonymous 05/12/2022	Took him for CMSC250 his first semester teaching, and had a pretty decent experience. The class was mostly organized and he knew the content pretty well. Unfortunately 330 this semester wasn't the same. While the class was organized well, cliffs lectures were very difficult to follow along with. He seemed to not be interested in the material, and would speed through content and wouldn't/struggled to break down complex topics. This was especially a problem when it came to Rust, which is pretty complex and we covered in the last 3 weeks of the semester. I went to almost all lectures this year, and for each I found myself feeling disengaged with the content. I found myself learning most of the content by carefully reading the lecture slides after the lecture was over, and looking at outside resources. All in all cliff is a great guy and clearly cares about his students, but his lectures weren't up to what I was expecting for a CS course.
Cliff Bakalian CMSC330 ☆☆☆☆ Anonymous 05/03/2022	While I don't vibe with his lecturing style, Cliff is a very knowledgeable and nice professor! I had external issues this semester and was really scared to talk to him about it, but he didn't ask any questions and was extremely understanding-- more so than I thought any professor here would be. He obviously cares about the class content and students. He's new to teaching and has said he's constantly thinking of how to change the class for the better, so I think he'll only improve from here. If he's an option, definitely take him :)
Cliff Bakalian CMSC330 ☆☆☆☆ Expecting a B+ Anonymous 04/28/2022	In the Fall 2021 semester, Cliff Bakalian was the new instructor for CMSC250, and many of my friends who took him left with very positive impressions. Because of this, when I saw his name listed on Testudo for CMSC330 the following semester, I was very excited to sign up for his lecture section and learn more about the organization of programming languages. Unfortunately, I was left rather disappointed. CMSC330 is a very content-heavy class - the sheer amount of information being packed into a single week is astounding. However, students have already taken or gotten credit for CMSC131, CMSC132, and CMSC216 by this point, so learning new material should not be a foreign experience. Sadly, Cliff's lecture style left something to be desired. He usually seemed to prioritize covering as many slides as possible as opposed to focusing on the fundamentals. For example, one week we had a PowerPoint nearly 70 slides long - Cliff blasted through as fast as he could, and many of the pertinent examples provided he would go "I don't care about this," and skip straight past them. Consequently, by the time we got to more complicated topics, I was lost and confused as we didn't spend enough time on the fundamentals. I stopped going to his lectures about a month into the semester and decided to watch Professor Van Horn's recordings instead - while he could be monotonous at times, he took much more care with the material, and besides, there are a great number of very helpful TAs both in in-person and online office hours, so I got by that way. Overall, I wouldn't recommend taking CMSC330 with Cliff unless you can absorb lots of material very quickly. At least he responds to questions effectively.

Information	Review
Anwar Mamat CMSC330 ★★☆☆☆ Expecting an A Anonymous 01/11/2022	I guess Anwar's gone now, but in case he comes back... I would say he's a good lecturer. My main complaint would be that he never really slows down. We would go through a huge amount of slides everyday and sometimes it seemed like he was racing. 330 has a lot of content, so that's probably why. I don't personally take notes, but I don't think anyone could with how fast he goes. He still did a good job at explaining concepts and the slides were well made, so you could basically just study off of those. He was clearly frustrated this semester by the turnout in lecture. Clicker quizzes used to be 4% of the grade, basically making lecture attendance mandatory. They changed the policy in the first week of the semester I believe, since people could be in and out with COVID. He would make lots of comments to himself during lecture about how it's so hard to teach this semester with not that many people in lecture and with everyone wearing masks. I also guess that computers used to not be allowed in 330 lecture, but now they are? He would complain about people having computers out too sometimes, and how he couldn't do anything. The projects in this class weren't very difficult, except for the NFA to DFA project and maybe the first OCaml project. If you start early, you should be fine. There were two online midterms which were pretty fair. We had four 20 minute online quizzes in the semester that I found to be very difficult. 20 minutes was not enough time and they seemed a bit unnecessary (the last quiz was on a topic on the last midterm, which was a week before). The final was also in-person for some reason. People would complain on Piazza and the TAs said that the decision was made by the instructors. People tried to ask Mamat/Eastman to change it to in-person and they said they would think about, but they did nothing. Not a good look on their part, considering the online midterms were open book and this wasn't. Plus, many people expressed COVID concerns due to a in-person final, which was also ignored. All in all, if Anwar comes back, I would recommend him. I was planning on taking 433 with him, but they changed teachers. He seems to have been a bit disillusioned by teaching this semester by all his comments on lecture, but I do hope he comes back.
Roger Eastman CMSC330 ★★☆☆☆ Expecting an A+ Anonymous 01/01/2022	Not sure why he gets so much hype. Would not recommend taking him if you can take the other prof for 330 (assuming he's co teaching with a good prof....I think I heard Anwar is leaving so I can't tell you to take it with Anwar lol). He's tried to improve his lecture skills (he mentioned that he's heard he "only reads off the slides") but as the semester went on, he seemed to just drift back to his old ways. Often did not seem prepared for lecture. Fell behind Anwar as other reviews say. The projects and exams were good, but the projects are old so idk how much Eastman contributed to them. Exams were fine and were online except the final. No clicker quizzes which was really nice. They planned to replace clicker quizzes with weekly ELMS quizzes but only ended up doing two. Anyway, if he's co-teaching, I would recommend going with the prof that seems to actually take care of the course materials (by this I mean Anwar made the "textbook" slides and Eastman modified them, so for Eastman vs. Anwar I would go with Anwar).
Roger Eastman CMSC330 ★★☆☆☆ Expecting a B Anonymous 12/27/2021	Eastman is a very nice and approachable professor. However, his lectures were pretty boring, disorganized, and not very engaging. We also frequently fell behind Mamat's section of this class due to Eastman's slow pace during lecture. Exams were generally OK (except for the final, in my opinion) and the projects were straightforward. Office hours were a big help for solving project issues and clearing up questions from lecture. The TAs vary a lot in quality - I benefited from having a good TA for my discussion section, but this isn't universally the case.
Roger Eastman CMSC330 ★★☆☆☆ j11 12/26/2021	Eastman is a nice guy who wants to see you succeed. He is willing to spend significant time trying to help you in office hours. However, he is, in my opinion, a very boring and slow lecturer. It seemed to me like he had never seen the slides before trying to present them in class, and we frequently found ourselves far behind Mamat's classes because he did not cover content or answer student questions efficiently. He would reexplain half the lecture even if a student's question could be answered in a sentence. Assignments were generally not too hard. There is a lot of variation in the TA quality, but office hours can be a big help. Some of the exams were a bit challenging in terms of time but the content isn't too bad.

Information	Review
Roger Eastman CMSC330 ★★★★★ Expecting a B+ Anonymous 12/24/2021	Very good professor. Extremely approachable and nice to talk to. His class isnt challenging tbh. All the projects were pretty straightforward, with most of the later ones being all public and semi public. The exams were pretty fair too, if i paid more attention in lecture and had a better TA in discussion I probably would have gotten an A in the class.
Roger Eastman CMSC330 ★★★★☆ Expecting an A+ Anonymous 12/22/2021	Eastman is a really nice professor who is extremely approachable. However, I did feel like the class was kind of disorganized. Sometimes while lecturing it would seem like he was reading the slides for the first time, which made things hard to follow. However, I think that the class was pretty easy to follow and the content was taught in an understandable manner. I took the class in Spring 2020, so the unplanned transition to online definitely contributed to the lack of organization.
Roger Eastman CMSC330 ★★★★☆ Expecting a B+ Anonymous 12/18/2021	Dr. Eastman was pretty good. His lectures were kinda dry but he explained things decently well. He made extra videos out of lecture on topics that confused students, so that was really nice to see. If you're taking 330 with Eastman, you'll be fine.
Anwar Mamat CMSC330 ★★★★★ Expecting an A- Anonymous 09/30/2021	This professor was very good. He made sure that everything you needed to know was in the lecture slides. Make sure to follow what he is teaching and do the practice that he puts up and you will be fine. The assignments are tough if you do not both to learn/practice the material that he is teaching. As a teacher he seems to genuily enjoy teaching the students and it was a breath of fresh air compared to other professors here.
Michael Hicks CMSC330 ★★★★☆ Expecting a P Anonymous 07/28/2021 🇵🇪	Dr. Hicks is nice enough but lectures too quickly IMHO. Maybe he was different before COVID tho. The TA's however are amazing, especially Shilpa, and got me through projects, quizzes, and exams. Projects are difficult but not too bad if you start early. My advice, watch the discussion videos
Anwar Mamat CMSC330 ★★★★★ Anonymous 07/22/2021 🇵🇪	He's great! Goes very fast but at least for 330, everything you need to know is on the slides anyway.
Anwar Mamat CMSC330 ★★★★★ Expecting a B Anonymous 05/27/2021 🇵🇪	Had him for CMSC132 and had to take him again because he's great. Would take another class with him if I could.
Michael Hicks CMSC330 ★★★★★ Expecting an A Anonymous 05/17/2021 🇵🇪	Hicks lectures very quickly, but is willing to field every question. Project expectations and due dates were clear and fair, although some of them could be quite time consuming. Exams were easy enough and from lecture, and quizzes were announced and were challenging.

Information	Review
Anwar Mamat CMSC330 ★★☆☆☆ Expecting an A- Anonymous 05/11/2021 🗨️	Anwar manages to keep the lecture engaging and entertaining the whole class, he's a great professor and I have no doubt I would have received a higher grade had I taken this class in-person. Genuine guy who really cares about his students and offers them a lot of resources and opportunities to ask for help in office hours.
Ankit Chandnani CMSC330 ★★☆☆☆ Expecting an A+ Anonymous 04/14/2021 🗨️	goes above and beyond to help students, you could say he'd be willing to take a trip to the moon and back to help you out. best TA ever!
Michael Hicks CMSC330 ★★☆☆☆ Anonymous 04/06/2021 🗨️	The class is pretty chill, but I have a feeling he lectures way too quickly to try and cover alot of material.
Michael Hicks CMSC330 ★☆☆☆☆ Anonymous 03/04/2021 🗨️	His lecture is boring, and you wouldn't understand anything. Anwar Mamat is way better
Ashan Panduwawala CMSC330 ★★☆☆☆ Expecting an A Anonymous 01/25/2021 🗨️	Ashan was always a great TA and he was always really helpful during office hours.
David Van Horn CMSC330 ★★☆☆☆ Expecting an A Anonymous 12/28/2020 🗨️	David Van Horn is clearly incredibly knowledgable on the topics that he teaches, however, his lectures are rather dull and lacking on student engagement. If you're able to focus through his lectures, you will do a great job, but I often found that I would zone out at some point and then fall behind his fast-paced lectures entirely and resort to watching Anwar's lectures instead. The class as a whole is easy if you put the time in, but that being said the work is constant and unrelenting, the expectations are high, and if you fall behind you will have a very hard time catching up.
Anwar Mamat CMSC330 ★★☆☆☆ Anonymous 12/20/2020 🗨️	He is boring but the content is fine. He doesn't really care much about his students but the TAs are awesome. Start projects the day they are posted and you will be in good shape.
David Van Horn CMSC330 ★★☆☆☆ Expecting an A tybug 12/20/2020 🗨️	DVH is a decent lecturer, but is very monotone, though I didn't mind that personally. Not much more to say except that I disliked having graded clicker quizzes. If you don't attend lecture the onus is on you to know the material, but you shouldn't be punished with a 0 on the clicker quizzes on top of that. But YMMV.
Anwar Mamat CMSC330 ★★☆☆☆ Expecting an A- Anonymous 12/15/2020 🗨️	Not a good lecturer, because he goes super fast over complicated material, and could be a bit more civil, but that's really the only main complaint. Clicker questions are not the worst and his slides are very comprehensive, the projects are fairly reasonable to do (better than 216's for sure) and the exams were fair too. Nothing completely out of the blue. Some TAs were really really helpful too and were responsive on Piazza. Overall, since 330 is usually co-taught, you should be fine taking either Anwar or the other professor.

Information	Review
David Van Horn CMSC330 ★★★★☆ Expecting an A- Anonymous 12/15/2020 🗨️	DVH is a good professor, but somewhat unremarkable. His lectures are kinda dry, but maybe that's just because we were online. The projects were interesting and fun, and overall I enjoyed this class.
Roger Eastman CMSC330 ★★★★★ Expecting an A+ Anonymous 11/17/2020 🗨️	Dr. Eastman is the best CS professor!! I would love to take more classes with him, but he doesn't teach that many courses. I took 330 with him, and he was great!!
Roger Eastman CMSC330 ★★★★★ Expecting a B Anonymous 05/25/2020 🗨️	Dr. Eastman is a good lecturer who is knowledgeable about the topics that he teaches. While this class is tough, Dr. Eastman helps you understand the theory of everything you need to know. In addition, he is friendly and approachable, so if you have any questions about the course content, you can go to his office hours for further understanding. He is a good CMSC 330 instructor.
Roger Eastman CMSC330 ★★★☆☆ Expecting an A+ Anonymous 05/25/2020 🗨️	Dr. Eastman's a really nice guy, but I don't think he's a really good professor. He's a little bit disorganized, and sometimes when he lectures it seems like he's seeing the slides for the first time (usually it's Prof. Mamat's slides but just tweaked a little bit). Sometimes, albeit rarely, if you ask him a question in class about Ruby or OCaml, he'd respond vaguely and say that he doesn't code much in those languages, which is understandable but makes me uneasy. Also sometimes on projects you have to use things he skimmed over in lecture/haven't learned (but Mamat's class did go over). Thankfully, Mamat puts up a whole bunch of practice quizzes/exams on the class webpage, and they rarely deviate from the real thing. Also start projects super early. If you get stuck just look at discussion code from github, they're pretty similar to most of the projects. If you wanna learn something, I'd suggest taking Mamat, but if you want a laid back environment, I'd choose Eastman. But since they co-teach, I feel like you're sorta at a disadvantage with Eastman.
Anwar Mamat CMSC330 ★★★★★ Expecting an A+ Anonymous 05/21/2020 🗨️	Anwar flies through the material very quickly, but that's just because there's a lot of stuff to cover. This semester he managed the online transition due to the pandemic quite well, and he toned down the amount of work we had to do. The slides really are the primary resource in the class, so study those, look at them when doing projects, and you'll do great!
Ashan Panduwawala CMSC330 ★★★★★ Expecting an A Anonymous 03/11/2020 🗨️	Really nice during office hours. Does not sound condescending nor mean and he answers questions clearly.
Roger Eastman CMSC330 ★★★☆☆ Anonymous 03/11/2020 🗨️	He's your average professor that goes off the slides and tries to go into detail into explaining the concepts. His pace is slow but is ineffective at teaching the material. He co-teaches with Anwar so the material would be the same, luckily his lectures were recorded. Still needed to go for clicker questions though. His project descriptions were horrible, that the piazza is flooded with questions on clarity all the time.
Roger Eastman CMSC330 ★★★★☆ Expecting a B Anonymous 01/10/2020	Good stuff, informative slides. Nice guy, good professor. Super easy exams when he helps to make it. Sometimes lectures can get long and slow to cover. Good thing he records his lectures so I can watch it at 2x speed after!

Information	Review
Roger Eastman CMSC330 ☆☆☆☆☆ Expecting an A+ Anonymous 12/21/2019	He makes the exams and the class as easy as possible. he is a fun lecturer in comparison to others.
Anwar Mamat CMSC330 ☆☆☆☆ Expecting a C+ Anonymous 12/18/2019	Solid guy but not a good lecturer. Reads off slides. Lectures are so useless but attendance is mandatory via clickers. Slides are good.
Roger Eastman CMSC330 ☆☆☆☆☆ Expecting an A Anonymous 12/10/2019	He's a very good professor. He also has a good sense of humor and usually conveys topics well. I thought the projects were difficult and they caused me a lot of stress. Having a good TA helped for many of the projects. If it is relevant, he definitely has big gamer energy (for one, he teaches the game programming class, and for two, he's talked about playing 2000 Quake, so you know he's an OG Gamer).
Shriraj Gandhi CMSC330 ☆☆☆☆☆ Expecting an A Anonymous 05/15/2019	He's a great TA, and very understanding if you have a tight situation. He has been a TA for 330 for quite a while so he knows his stuff very well. If you have him as a TA you should be fine.b
Roger Eastman CMSC330 ☆☆☆☆ Expecting an A Anonymous 05/14/2019	okay, he's chill and nice and all, but my god i cannot pay attention during any of his lectures. 330 is a fast paced class in general and if you don't pay attention for one second you'll get swept away and won't understand the rest of the lecture. on top of that he sometimes doesnt explain concepts properly and just explains them in a very broad sense. i mean he's not the worst professor but i really did not like his teaching style, but who knows maybe that's just the way 330 is
Anwar Mamat CMSC330 ☆☆☆☆☆ Expecting an A Anonymous 04/06/2019	Decent lecturer, although he goes a bit fast at times. He is a nice guy and has some funny stories.
Anwar Mamat CMSC330 ☆☆☆☆ Expecting an A Anonymous 12/24/2018	Anwar is not a terrible instructor, but not great either. He mostly reads off the slides and often rushes through topics. He tells a lot of stories and goes on a lot of tangents, which would be fine if it didn't mean rushing through challenging topics. I often felt like I didn't learn much by going to lecture and wished I didn't need to go, but there are clicker questions in order to enforce attendance. The material itself is very cool and the TAs for 330 are phenomenal. Also, Hicks is supposedly incredible, so if he's an option, take him. Otherwise, you'll be OK with Anwar, you just might need to put in a little extra time and effort.

Information	Review
Anwar Mamat CMSC330 ★★★★★ Expecting an A Anonymous 12/19/2018	Anwar is a pretty good lecturer and incredibly funny. His exams are fair, the average my semester was an 80% on the nose. The only valid gripe people have with him is the pacing of his lectures. He does tend to fly through some of the material on the slides, but if you try to pay attention, you'll be fine. Even moreso, all of his lectures are online, and his lectures are recorded and put online in case you missed them, so you should be fine. The projects will be more challenging than the ones you have had so far in 132 and 216 because you will be forced to navigate through different languages and different concepts, but for the most part, you will survive. People have gripes with him for having clicker questions that force you to come to lecture, but that really isn't criticism, because you should come to lecture anyway and he's giving you easy points that'll bump your grade at the end of the semester. All around a nice professor and person, and I definitely recommend you take 330 with Anwar. I've never had Eastman, but I hear he's ok too.
Roger Eastman CMSC330 ★★★★★ Anonymous 12/11/2018	Hes' really nice and doesn't go too fast. Somehow made going to his 8am lecture worth it (lol rip). He hates clickers just as much as us and tried to make it as painless as possible (sometimes just straight up gave us the answers). Really sympathetic to students and the undergrad struggles. Love the dude. Would take a course with him again.
Shriraj Gandhi CMSC330 ★★★★★ Expecting an F Anonymous 11/30/2018	While I'm preparing to fail this class, I know it is 100% not the fault of this TA. Not only is he extremely smart (causally mentions interviewing with Google [goosh]) he brings memes to the class room. This reassures that the class room is not only a place to grow mentally but a place a grow our connection to the course through humor. The memes were the only beam of light in this course. Honestly though, the man is intelligent and helpful. I personally thought he was pretty funny, as well. At times, he did a better job then the main teacher. Thanks Shriraj! Sorry I didn't know your name til week 10.
Cameron Moy CMSC330 ★★★★★ Expecting a B Anonymous 07/24/2018	he teaches the concept pretty well, although the coding question he gives on exam are hard
Michael Hicks CMSC330 ★★★★☆ Expecting an A- Anonymous 07/11/2018	Great lecturer - he's very clear and easy to understand. He wants the best for his students. If you reach out to him when the workload is unreasonable, he will try to adjust the coursework/scores accordingly to help his students succeed. However, do not expect him to help you if you are slacking.
Anwar Mamat CMSC330 ★★★★☆ Expecting a B Anonymous 05/13/2018	He is extremely engaging and I honestly understood the material so well after. He goes fast but the slides are online so you can just note what he says. I'm a visual learner and he's the best at explaining through code examples that he writes on the spot. I would say he is definitely a better professor to have for 330.
Niki Vazou CMSC330 ★★★★☆ Expecting a B+ Anonymous 05/10/2018	She can be a little difficult to understand at times, but it is nothing compared to other TAs and professors I've had in the past. She is very knowledgeable about the content covered in the course despite this semester being the first time she taught 330. Honestly, she is a fine lecturer and if for whatever reason you don't find it enjoyable, you can always watch the recorded lectures from other professors or even go to their lecture instead. My biggest gripe with her lecture was not her, but the incredibly rude students who would often talk loudly with one another while she was talking! If I could give her any advice, it would be to lay down the law and tell those people outright to shut up.

Information	Review
Cameron Moy CMSC330 ★ ★ ★ ★ ★ Anonymous 05/09/2018	He was very energetic and amazing. Learned all of the material from him and not the professor. AMAZING TA
Anwar Mamat CMSC330 ★ ★ ★ ★ ☆ Anonymous 04/21/2018	Goes over slides pretty quickly, but he is pretty engaging in my opinion. Just sit in the front.
Michael Hicks CMSC330 ★ ★ ★ ★ ★ Expecting an A Anonymous 04/19/2018	Lecture: Prof. Hicks uses slides mostly as an outline, and occasionally uses the whiteboard as well. In some cases he edits a slide temporarily for examples. He's really helpful in clarifying concepts to those who ask. As of spring 2018, Prolog is being replaced by Rust in 330. I believe Dr. Hicks had a major role in this decision, and for that I'm bumping this to 5 stars. While I didn't find the material too challenging or interesting, going to lecture did not feel like a chore at all.
Anwar Mamat CMSC330 ★ ★ ☆ ☆ ☆ Anonymous 04/17/2018	what the heck is wrong with this dude. He goes over his lectures really fast. Cannot take notes and cannot understand anything.
Niki Vazou CMSC330 ★ ★ ★ ★ ☆ Expecting a B Anonymous 04/11/2018	Enjoyable and always seems to be in a good mood. She is clearly so smart and her class is straight forward, co-taught with Gilray and an enjoyable lecture. No complaints!
Thomas Gilray CMSC330 ★ ★ ★ ★ ☆ Expecting a B Anonymous 04/11/2018	This guy really knows his stuff! So nice and very easy to follow.
Shriraj Gandhi CMSC330 ★ ★ ★ ★ ★ Expecting an A- Anonymous 04/04/2018	Great TA, very hardworking. Will answer your questions swiftly.
Michael Strauch CMSC330 ★ ★ ★ ☆ ☆ Expecting an A- Anonymous 04/01/2018	A solid okay. Handwriting terrible but a pretty nice guy. Great at teaching discussion not so good for office hours

Information	Review
Jeffrey Foster CMSC330 ★★★★☆ Expecting a B-thunderd568 12/23/2017	Super friendly guy. Lectures can be super fucking confusing (at least if he is teaching 330). He's a reasonable option for any class. With the curve, I got a B- and finished the class with a 77%. So that alone is worth having him for.
Anwar Mamat CMSC330 ★★★★☆ Expecting an A me 12/16/2017	The lectures were way too fast and not engaging. By the end of the semester, I was skipping class and watching Foster's lectures online. The tests and projects were fair, although we were left to just figure out basic SQL on the last one, which was annoying. The class itself is an interesting one, and old tests are provided for study. It's certainly not the end of the world or anything if you have Mamat, you'll still learn things, just probably not as much as if you had Foster.
Anwar Mamat CMSC330 ★★★★☆ Expecting a B+ Anonymous 12/16/2017	Mamat is a very accommodating professor, but his lectures are completely worthless. On more than one occasion, he would explain the material in the first 45 minutes while barely moving through the slides, and then rapidly go through them, only doing quizzes AND SOMETIMES SKIPPING IMPORTANT THINGS ALTOGETHER! Fortunately, if Foster/another professor posts their lectures online, the class will be a breeze. Also, the project descriptions are very easy to understand, and the public tests are usually pretty robust, which is great especially if you're used to Nelson's "figure it out if you can" approach. I like the guy, but I didn't attend lecture after the first month and still got an A on the final just by reading slides and doing projects. That pretty much sums up how important his lectures are right there.
Anwar Mamat CMSC330 ★★★★☆ Expecting a C Anonymous 12/14/2017	I had cmssc330 with Anwar and between him and Hicks/Foster, he's probably the worst professor to take for this class. Anwar is a cool dude, but his lectures were terrible and he moves at a pace that was too fast for most students to catch everything. His explanations are less than clear, and I soon ended up watching Hick's online lectures to try and get the rest of the material. There were two midterms, fairly tricky but not too bad. Both of them were pretty long, and took the full 75 mins right up to the line - they really pack the exams. Definitely study the exams from previous semesters and drill ocaml/prolog programming if you want to do well on these. Otherwise, it's actually an awesome class and the material is really interesting despite the workload. I felt pretty solid in my standing as a software eng. after this class, because a lot of concepts across different languages kinda clicked for me. Get Cameron Moy as your TA if you can :) Good luck!
Chau-Wen Tseng CMSC330 ★☆☆☆☆ Anonymous 12/19/2014 ⓘ	I was TA for this course and I had very bitter experience with Prof. Tseng. He has been very mean to TAs, I found him instigating my advisor against me for some minor issue. Stay away from this course and this professor. Thanks to Prof. Tseng for inspiring me to not join academia after my PhD.
Nelson Padua-Perez CMSC330 ★★★★★ Anonymous 05/19/2014 ⓘ	I've taken Nelson for CMSC216/CMSC330 , and he has to be one of my favorite CS professors. He explains the material well and tries to keep it fun in the process. If you are deciding between Nelson and another professor for a CMSC class - do yourself a favor and take Nelson. You will learn a bunch and have fun in the process.

Information	Review
Chau-Wen Tseng CMSC330 ☆☆☆☆☆ Expecting an A- Anonymous 12/20/2013 ⓘ	Although lecture tends to be dry (like most CS courses), Tseng makes up for it by truly being a reliable and helpful professor. Exams and quizzes are incredibly fair and he even provides a large amount of practice problems and solutions. Furthermore he's almost always available through email and piazza (the class piazza had a 16 minute response time). I remember once I was up at 1:45am working on a project the same day it was due and he was still up answering questions for us. Although class can be boring (and optional if you want to skip and learn on your own via the slides he posts online), prof tseng overall provides a fair course that is truly a breath of fresh air in comparison to 216, 250 and 351 (especially 351...)
Chau-Wen Tseng CMSC330 ☆☆☆☆☆ Expecting a C Anonymous 12/19/2013 ⓘ	Tseng is a great professor. I am getting a C, but I take full responsibility for it. If you ever needed help he was more than willing to help. Also, he is very fair with the projects and tests. By far the fairest assignments and projects I've seen in the CS department. While lectures can get a bit boring as he does have an unenthusiastic voice, he is very knowledgeable about the material and puts all of the lecture slides online. He speaks clearly and explains himself well. Definitely recommend him if you have the option.
Chau-Wen Tseng CMSC330 ☆☆☆☆☆ Expecting an A sbl03 11/27/2013 ⓘ	One of the best CS professors up to this point. He is a blazing fast grader - you will get your exam grades back in 1-2 days usually. There is so much material on the course page, and the exams and quizzes follow the exact format as previous semesters. There is no chance that you will feel underprepared for an exam or quiz if you do the practice material. The exams are graded fairly for the most part. He is also very nice and helpful - he checks Piazza very frequently and answers EVERY. SINGLE. QUESTION. that students post, or at least endorses a correct student answer. The projects are mostly fair. They are harder and take more time than 216 projects, but they are manageable if you start a good time in advance. A good portion of the projects are put in the secret tests, unfortunately. As for the lectures, they are not extremely useful since he posts all his slides online. I don't bother going to discussion unless taking a quiz.
Michael Hicks CMSC330 ☆☆☆☆☆ Expecting an A zaqu413 05/16/2013 ⓘ	Lecture: Dr. Hicks rarely used the lecture slides, but posted them online. Most of lecture was going over the concepts and answering questions, he likes questions. Projects: We had 5 projects, 2 with Ruby, 2 with Ocaml and 1 using Prolog. Overall they were pretty difficult, except for the first project, it wasn't very hard, but was very long. You really need to start the projects within a couple days of them being due, the concepts are more theoretical in this class, in 131/132/216 everything was fairly straightforward. Discussion: We had 5 quizzes (announced) and they were generally on the easy side, just testing basic knowledge of what was going on during lecture. I had Richard Johnson as my TA, he was very helpful. No discussion programming projects. Exams: We had one exam on Ruby/NFA/DFA/Regex/CFG and maybe some other stuff. This exam was pretty straightforward and easy. The second midterm was on Ocaml/Operational Semantics/Multithreading, this exam was pretty hard. The final was a little easier than the second exam.

Information	Review
Larry Herman CMSC330 ★★★★☆ Expecting an A+ dfarias 03/02/2013 ⓘ	I can understand the people who really dislike him, because he can be quite harsh. However, in the end he is quite competent as a teacher, and provides good resources online through worksheets and slides. He also teaches pretty well. If you have to take him over a mediocre professor, it'll be fine as long as you use the resources available.
Chau-Wen Tseng CMSC330 ★★★★☆ Expecting a B+ Anonymous 08/31/2012 ⓘ	Some people like good lecturers, but I liked the fact that I could appropriate class time to do more productive things, like sleep. All the tools to get an A are on the class page (slides, practice problems, past exams). Also, it benefits you to start the project early since a couple of times we had quizzes and exams before a project was due. A couple of times I regretted focusing on the quizzes/exams then the projects because I then realized I would've been pro at the material if I had just worked on the project first.
Chau-Wen Tseng CMSC330 ★★★★☆ Expecting an A+ OtG 03/21/2012 ⓘ	Tseng is a pretty good professor, but his lectures are nothing special. The amount of material he distributes on the class website is ridiculous. In addition to all the slides from class and discussion, he posts practice quizzes/exams, the previous 4 versions of the quiz/exam, and general practice questions for each subject before every quiz/exam. He's an accommodating guy; just make sure to take the quizzes and exams seriously, because they cover a lot and are a bit part of the grade.
Jeffrey Foster CMSC330 ★★★★★ Expecting a C Anonymous 05/23/2011 ⓘ	He is one of the best professor I have ever had and he is totally fair. He knows the materials very well and there is always a decent curve on his grades around ten points. He loves his students and never let them go down and if you need him please go to his office hours. His both midterms are long but easy. %50 of the grade is for projects. If you do your project and get around average for your test you can pass the class easily with b/c . He is talking very very fast but you will get used to it. He tests you on what you know not what you memorize. His hardest project was 4th project and the 5th one..... so do your best on the first 3 ... they are not easy but interesting and doable without any TA's help. He is always on time and on his schedule. he provides solution for all of his tests and quizzes.. he is awesome. I will take a class with him if i can
Jeffrey Foster CMSC330 ★★★★★ Expecting an A+ xenonscreams 05/16/2011 ⓘ	He isn't perfect, but there's one reason I'm giving him five stars: I can tell he actually tries to adjust his teaching style as opposed to holding onto how he teaches the course every time. This means that over time, he is going to become an even better professor as he drops things that didn't work and holds on to things that did. For example, in 2008 someone commented that it was "purely a slides class." A friend who took the course a couple years back also said it was very slide-heavy at the time. This semester, he used the slides sometimes, but didn't teach purely off of the slides. They played more of a supportive role, and oftentimes he didn't even use the slides at all and gave several real-time examples and the like. Projects were kind of a mix. I thought they were mostly fun, but toward the end the public tests dealt with nothing more than basic functionality, which isn't a bad thing, but you have to be aware of it and actually test your code. Practice exams, practice problems, and slides were sufficient for studying for exams, but I had to study pretty hard to get As (according to my browser, I visited the class website 226 times this semester). I know a lot of people care about this, so yes, there was a curve even though the raw mean was a 74. Potential drawbacks: I never asked for an extension in his class, but I did hear he was relatively unaccommodating about them. If you are taking this class at the same time as, say, a class with Meesh, and your life is hard, you should try to finish your assignments for this class on time and ask Meesh for the extension. If you know ahead of time you're going to have a really tough semester for whatever reason, I'd consider holding back on this course until your life clears up a little, if you can afford to. tl;dr not perfect, but good and improving, definitely worth taking

Information	Review
Jeffrey Foster CMSC330 ☆☆☆☆☆ Expecting an A tobiasfunke 05/16/2011 ⓘ	I highly recommend Professor Foster for cmsc330. His lectures are very clear. He enjoys class participation and answers questions very clearly and patiently. The projects are all do-able as long as you don't procrastinate. He's also a genuinely nice guy. There is a reasonable curve at the end of the course so if you're borderline on a grade a bump up is not out of the question.
Jeffrey Foster CMSC330 ☆☆☆☆☆ Expecting a B Anonymous 04/28/2011 ⓘ	Great guy, hard course. This course will work you to death, and then some. Ocaml and Ruby projects are hard, and are nothing (conceptually) like the projects you are used to C, Java, and Assembly. Good luck managing the lengthy projects with the difficult concepts of the class, which also lend themselves to harder exams than in previous CS courses. I wish I wasn't taking 19 credits this semester and could put in more work to get the A in this class, but I am quite satisfied with Foster, he's a genius, and quite possibly the smartest professor I know. Since CMSC330 is required for CS majors and minors, as well as CE majors, there's no way around taking this course, but take it with Foster, you'll learn a lot and feel better about your 400 level's after this course.
Chau-Wen Tseng CMSC330 ☆☆☆☆☆ Anonymous 02/12/2011 ⓘ	The class doesn't really require a teacher because it's mostly just about learning the programming languages. There are a few more advanced concepts that Tseng explained decently. The projects take up a lot of time, but you will learn a lot from them. And at the end of the semester the projects die down significantly, which is nice because it gives you a chance to put in more time for your other classes. Some of the projects can be extremely frustrating though, especially when he doesn't give you an easy way to test them. For example, to test your code for one of our projects would have required days of writing out test inputs and figuring out their correct outputs. But even if you fail one project, it's still possible to get an A. Anyway, I'd say Tseng was fine for this class.
Michael Hicks CMSC330 ☆☆☆☆☆ Expecting an A collegeguy367 07/07/2010 ⓘ	Professor Hicks is, in my opinion, one of the best professors the computer science department has to offer. He is interactive and engaging with students by focusing more on sample code and examples generated in class rather than simply reading off the lecture slides. He even makes the boring material seem interesting. Also, he is very receptive to his students and will try to answer most questions in class, or will come back the next lecture with a solution to a question. Hicks focuses his material around student needs rather than curriculum requirements. I really enjoyed his CMSC330 class, and though it was very difficult, in my opinion, his teaching style was very effective and helpful. I will definitely be taking other classes with this professor including CMSC433. Highly Recommended!!
Jeffrey Foster CMSC330 ☆☆☆☆☆ Expecting an A+ random 06/08/2010 ⓘ	He is a very good professor. This class is a bit dry, given it is very theoretical. But despite that, Foster made it quite interesting. He is a very nice guy, answers questions patiently and is an easy grader (decent curve). All material can just be learned from slides. This class is all about projects, where starting early is the key. Strongly recommended with Foster.
Michael Hicks CMSC330 ☆☆☆☆☆ Anonymous 04/15/2010 ⓘ	Professor Hicks spends the lecture showing examples of code (which he generates during lecture) of what he tries to teach, while also posting lecture slides (which he doesn't really use in class). Ultimately, I found this style really helpful. It promotes attendance and understanding because you get to see the concepts in action if you attend class, but you also have the slides to refer back to. I enjoyed Hicks as a professor and plan to have him as a professor again.

Information	Review
Chau-Wen Tseng CMSC330 ☆☆☆☆☆ Anonymous 10/12/2009 ⓘ	Chau-wen taught this class with Foster, who seemed to think that all of us were geniuses. Chau-Wen seemed to be the weaker prof of the two. Foster controlled the primary parts of the exams and projects. He turned simples project into massive, tedious projects. So far in the semester, at least half the students never even finish the projects. As a teacher, he is not the most amazing teacher ever. He simply reads off the slides, and I never go to class because of it anymore. I don't know why they decided to make the projects so hard for us this semester. This class definitely isnt as easy as it used to be. It's much harder mostly because of the projects. I'm taking this class simultaneously with 311 and it's a living hell. Whatever you do, do NOT take this class with another programming class. Take something like 351 or a decent 400 level class instead.
Chau-Wen Tseng CMSC330 ☆☆☆☆☆ Expecting an A fuzzyLogic 12/28/2008 ⓘ	Passable via the power points as I don't remember attending any lectures after the first week. Midterms didn't fit a nice difficulty/length ratio. Curve was appropriate however. Projects were easy. The final was easy if you studied previous/practice exams and the power points carefully.
Jeffrey Foster CMSC330 ☆☆☆☆☆ blackshellbrowser 12/23/2008 ⓘ	Great guy. He did try to make the lectures interesting (considering it's purely a slides class). Projects were for the most part reasonable (and pretty interesting imo). Only exception was the last project he gave. It was difficult and since it was a week before the final it wasn't pretty. Exams can be a little tricky and sometimes be a little too long, but nothing terrible. He is a lenient grader. What I like is he reserves about 3-4% of your final grade as "class participation" to bump you up if you did terrible on one project but good on the others. He also doesn't just use cutoffs as a guide, he looks at everyones standings and sees if he can bump them up.
Chau-Wen Tseng CMSC330 ☆☆☆☆☆ Expecting a B pluralfacade 12/08/2008 ⓘ	Chau-Wen's class was....an interesting experience. Like many CS teachers, he is an expert in his area of research and really knows what he's talking about, but he ocassionally struggles in conveying this information to students who know nothing about it to begin with. His tests were probably his greatest weakness. They had good coverage of the required material, but the combination of the tests being both too long and having extremely challenging problems made them pretty much impossible to finish. Towards the end of the semester, he started to deviate from his own syllabus, but this was both good and bad. Instead of giving us Java projects at the end as originally planned, he instead put more focus into new programming languages, which proved to be helpful since Java had already been covered to a great detail in previous classes. The grades for the class were pretty low throughout the semester and many people were worried, but Chau-Wen had a pretty nice curve at the end.
Chau-Wen Tseng CMSC330 ☆☆☆☆☆ Expecting a B Anonymous 07/01/2008 ⓘ	His lecture were long and probably the most boring I ever been in. His exams covered so much material and it was impossible for even the smart kids in the class to finish. He also did not stick to the syllabus.
Chau-Wen Tseng CMSC330 ☆☆☆☆☆ Expecting an A allie 06/04/2008 ⓘ	He gives you very detailed powerpoint notes that he posts online. I didn't have to take notes. He gave us good review materials for all the exams. The projects were reasonable. Overall he was a pretty good professor although lectures weren't too exciting...but how many comp sci lectures are?

Information	Review
Atif Memon CMSC330 ★★★★☆ Expecting a B Anonymous 02/13/2008 ⓘ	Very good teacher, you will definitely learn a lot from him. He keeps class light and interesting, constantly forces class members to go up to the board and do examples. Makes sure you're learning and not just losing him. Also VERY approachable. The drawback I had were his tests. If you want to do well on his tests, be prepared to hang around his office every day and do tons and TONS of extra problems. The average grade on our first test was something like a 28. His TAs were also really good, but there were several problems with project descriptions/testing (which the TAs were in charge of). It was all resolved, however, and they were generally lenient when they messed up. Overall, Id certainly recommend this guy.
Atif Memon CMSC330 ★★★★★ Expecting an A Anonymous 12/18/2007 ⓘ	He's a great professor. I had him for CMSC330, and he tells good jokes, keeps class interesting, and is an effective teacher. I really felt like a learned a *lot* in the course, and the class will probably be very useful to things I do in the future. During the semester, I only missed one lecture (and I wish I didn't even miss that one), because the lectures were always engaging and informative. The one drawback is that he does not use the grades server, but this is a minor one. He is very approachable. Highly recommended.

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